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July  
17

**Monthly  
Compilation**

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# CURRENT AFFAIRS

## SEPTEMBER 2026

Complete Monthly Compilation

### Topics Covered

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- 3 States in News
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- 5 Economy, Business & Banking
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- 13 MCQs with Explanations



**Gurpreet Singh**

Punjab Police SI · Rank 2 (713/800)

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## **How to use this magazine**

- Read the **Punjab Corner** and **Cover Stories** first - Punjab exams ask these most.
- Every topic has **Why in News**, **Key Facts** and an **Exam Point**. Revise the Exam Points twice.
- Each section ends with a **Revision Box** - use it the night before the exam.
- Solve the **MCQs** at the end without looking, then read the explanations.

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# 1. Punjab Corner

## Punjab raises DA/DR from 42% to 50%

### Why in News?

The Punjab Government increased Dearness Allowance (DA) for employees and Dearness Relief (DR) for pensioners.

### Key Facts

- Old rate: **42%**
- New rate: **50%** (increase of 8 percentage points)
- Beneficiaries: state government employees (DA) and pensioners (DR)

### 📌 Exam Point

- DA is paid to serving employees; DR is paid to pensioners - both offset inflation.

## India's first soil-carbon payments to farmers of Punjab and Haryana

### Why in News?

India made its first-ever payments to farmers for storing carbon in their soil.

### Key Facts

- Amount: over **Rs 2.9 crore**
- Farmers: **2,550** farmers
- States: **Punjab and Haryana**
- Rewards practices that keep carbon in soil (e.g. not burning stubble, less tillage)

### 📌 Exam Point

- First soil-carbon payments in India → farmers of Punjab & Haryana.

## Green Forge Complex inaugurated at BRIC-NABI, Mohali

### Why in News?

A new research facility was opened at the National Agri-Food Biotechnology Institute (BRIC-NABI) in Mohali.

### Key Facts

- Place: **BRIC-NABI, Mohali (Punjab)**
- Purpose: advanced research on genetically modified (GM) crops under controlled conditions
- BRIC = Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council (under the Department of Biotechnology)

### 📌 Exam Point

- Green Forge Complex → BRIC-NABI, Mohali → GM crop research.

## Punjab sportspersons in news

### Why in News?

Two players from Punjab made national headlines in September.

### Key Facts

- **Abhishek Sharma** (Amritsar) hit a **30-ball T20I century** against Afghanistan - the fastest by an Indian.
- Shot-putter **Tajinderpal Singh Toor** (Moga) was first named India's male flag-bearer for the Asian Games 2026; he was later replaced by kabaddi star Pawan Sehrawat.

### 📌 Exam Point

- Fastest T20I hundred by an Indian (30 balls) → Abhishek Sharma.

### 📄 At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                            |                                               |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Punjab DA/DR               | 42% → 50%                                     |
| First soil-carbon payments | 2,550 farmers, Punjab & Haryana, Rs 2.9 crore |
| Green Forge Complex        | BRIC-NABI, Mohali                             |
| 30-ball T20I hundred       | Abhishek Sharma vs Afghanistan                |

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## 2. Cover Stories of the Month

### 18th BRICS Summit 2026, New Delhi

#### Why in News?

India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi on 12-13 September 2026 as BRICS Chair for 2026.

#### Key Facts

- Theme: **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"**
- India's previous BRICS chairship: **2021**
- **New Delhi Declaration 2026**: 45 pages, **140 points**, adopted unanimously
- Condemned terrorism in all forms, including the **22 April 2025** terror attack in Jammu & Kashmir; zero tolerance for terrorism
- Backed a WTO-led trading system and the return of the WTO's two-tier dispute settlement
- Encouraged use of members' **local currencies** for cross-border payments
- Supported UN and UN Security Council reform; China and Russia backed a bigger UN role for **India and Brazil**
- PM Modi gave **10 recommendations** for a BRICS reform agenda
- **China** will chair BRICS and host the **19th Summit in 2027**

#### BRICS - Static Facts

|                         |                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Term 'BRIC' coined by   | Jim O'Neill (Goldman Sachs), 2001       |
| South Africa joined     | 2010 (BRIC became BRICS)                |
| BRICS bank              | New Development Bank (NDB), HQ Shanghai |
| 2026 Chair / 2027 Chair | India / China                           |

#### Exam Point

- 18th BRICS Summit → New Delhi (Bharat Mandapam), 12-13 Sept 2026.
- New Delhi Declaration → 140 points.

### PM Modi receives Uzbekistan's highest honour

#### Why in News?

PM Narendra Modi was conferred the **Oliy Darajali Do'stlik Order** (Order of Supreme Friendship) during his visit to Tashkent on 30 August 2026.

#### Key Facts

- Honour: Order of Supreme Friendship - Uzbekistan's highest honour
- India-Uzbekistan ties elevated to a **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**
- Key agreement: long-term supply of **uranium** to India (energy security)

### Exam Point

- Oliy Darajali Do'stlik Order → Uzbekistan → PM Modi (Tashkent).

## Ramon Magsaysay Awards 2026

### Why in News?

Winners of the 2026 Ramon Magsaysay Award, often called Asia's Nobel Prize, were announced on 31 August.

### Key Facts

- Started: **1958**
- Named after: **Ramon Magsaysay**, former President of the Philippines
- Ceremony: **Manila, Philippines**

| Winner    | Country    | Known for                                                                          |
|-----------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tommy Koh | Singapore  | Diplomat, international-law expert; key figure in UNCLOS negotiations              |
| Runa Khan | Bangladesh | Founder of 'Friendship' - health, education and climate resilience in remote areas |
| Bo Kyi    | Myanmar    | Human-rights activist; co-founder of AAPP (political prisoners)                    |

### Exam Point

- No Indian among the 2026 Magsaysay winners.
- Magsaysay Award started in 1958.

## Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2026 - cleaner-air city rankings

### Why in News?

Results of Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2026 were released. It ranks cities on the steps taken to reduce air pollution.

### Key Facts

- Assessed by State Level Monitoring Committees and the **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)**
- It is **not** a list of the least polluted cities - it rewards action taken
- Linked to **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)**; launched January 2019, initially 130 cities, target up to 40% cut in PM10 (baseline 2019-20)
- Lucknow's PM10 fell from 250 ug/m3 (2017-18) to 137 ug/m3

| Category                     | 1st                   | 2nd             | 3rd             |
|------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| I - above 10 lakh population | Lucknow (198)         | Indore (197)    | Jabalpur (195)  |
| II - 3 to 10 lakh            | Rourkela (198.5)      | Firozabad (195) | Guntur (195)    |
| III - below 3 lakh           | Kalinga Nagar (198.5) | Angul (196.5)   | Talcher (193.5) |

### Exam Point

- Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2026 top (10 lakh+) → Lucknow.

## 20th Asian Games 2026, Aichi-Nagoya (Japan)

### Why in News?

The 20th Asian Games began on 19 September 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan and run till 4 October 2026.

### Key Facts

- Mascot: **HONOHON** - from Japanese 'Honoho' meaning **flame**
- Official slogan: "**Imagine One Asia**"; opening ceremony theme: "Harmonic Heart Beat"
- Opening venue: Nagoya City Mizuho Park Athletic Stadium
- India's flag-bearers: **Manu Bhaker** (shooting) and **Pawan Sehrawat** (kabaddi, replaced Tajinderpal Singh Toor)
- India sent a **503-member** contingent; 300+ athletes on Asian Games debut
- Governing body: Olympic Council of Asia (est. 1982, HQ Kuwait City); first Asian Games: 1951, New Delhi

#### Exam Point

- Asian Games 2026 mascot → HONOHON (flame).
- First Asian Games → 1951, New Delhi.

## e-Shram portal completes 5 years

### Why in News?

The e-Shram portal, launched on 26 August 2021, completed five years on 26 August 2026.

### Key Facts

- Ministry: **Labour and Employment**; developed by NIC
- First national database of **unorganised workers** (Aadhaar-based)
- Each registered worker gets a 12-digit **Universal Account Number (UAN)**
- Registrations: **31.89 crore** (till August 2026); largest age group 18-40 years
- e-Shram 'One-Stop Solution' (21 October 2024) connects workers to **15 schemes**
- Available in **22 languages** through BHASHINI
- Top states by registration: Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal

| Scheme on e-Shram | Benefit                                            |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| PM-SYM            | Rs 3,000 monthly pension after 60 years            |
| PMSBY             | Rs 2 lakh accidental death / full disability cover |
| PMJJBY            | Rs 2 lakh life cover                               |

#### Exam Point

- e-Shram launched → 26 August 2021 (Ministry of Labour).

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                           |                                             |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 18th BRICS Summit         | New Delhi, 12-13 Sept; 19th in China (2027) |
| Uzbekistan honour to Modi | Oliy Darajali Do'stlik Order                |
| Magsaysay 2026            | Tommy Koh, Runa Khan, Bo Kyi                |
| Swachh Vayu (10 lakh+)    | Lucknow                                     |
| Asian Games 2026          | Aichi-Nagoya, Japan; mascot HONOHON         |
| e-Shram                   | 5 years; 31.89 crore workers                |



## 3. National Affairs

### Hepatitis B & C elimination by 2030

#### Why in News?

India restated its public-health goal on viral hepatitis.

#### Key Facts

- India aims to end **Hepatitis B and C** as public-health threats by **2030**.
- The target matches the WHO global goal and SDG 3.3.
- Static: the National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme began in **2018**; World Hepatitis Day is **28 July**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Hepatitis B & C elimination target year → 2030.

### Kavach 4.0 commissioned for the first time

#### Why in News?

First commissioning of the latest version of India's own train-protection system.

#### Key Facts

- First commissioned on **South Central Railway**.
- Covers **108 route km** between **Malkajgiri and Kamareddi** (Telangana).
- Static: Kavach is an indigenous Automatic Train Protection system developed by **RDSO**, Lucknow.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Kavach 4.0 first commissioned on → South Central Railway (Malkajgiri–Kamareddi, 108 km).

### Inter-State Council (Amendment) Order, 2026

#### Why in News?

The President changed the 1990 order that sets up the Inter-State Council.

#### Key Facts

- **President Droupadi Murmu** amended the **Inter-State Council Order, 1990**.
- The change was made through the **Inter-State Council (Amendment) Order, 2026**.
- The Council is set up under **Article 263** of the Constitution.
- Static: it was formed in 1990 on the advice of the **Sarkaria Commission**; the Prime Minister chairs it.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Inter-State Council constituted under → Article 263.

## National Formulary of India 2026

### Why in News?

New edition of India's reference book on rational use of medicines.

### Key Facts

- Launched by Union Minister of State for Health **Anupriya Patel** in New Delhi.
- Published by the **Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC)**.
- Static: IPC is headquartered in **Ghaziabad** (Uttar Pradesh), under the Health Ministry.

#### Exam Point

- National Formulary of India published by → Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission.

## Make in India completes 12 years

### Why in News?

Flagship manufacturing campaign marked its anniversary.

### Key Facts

- Completed **12 years** on **25 September 2026**.
- Launched on **25 September 2014** to make India a global manufacturing hub.
- Its symbol is a **lion** made of gears.

#### Exam Point

- Make in India launch date → 25 September 2014.

## Four ports notified as Mega Ports

### Why in News?

First mega-port notifications under the new ports law.

### Key Facts

- Deendayal, Jawaharlal Nehru, Paradip and Mundra** notified as mega ports.
- Notified under the **Indian Ports Act, 2025**.
- Mundra is a private port; the other three are major ports.

| Port               | State       |
|--------------------|-------------|
| Deendayal (Kandla) | Gujarat     |
| Jawaharlal Nehru   | Maharashtra |
| Paradip            | Odisha      |
| Mundra             | Gujarat     |

#### Exam Point

- Mega ports notified under → Indian Ports Act, 2025.

## SEMICON India 2026

### Why in News?

India's main semiconductor event, opened by the PM.

### Key Facts

- **PM Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **5th edition**.
- Venue: **Yashobhoomi**, New Delhi.
- Static: the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) was launched in **2021**.

### Exam Point

- 5th SEMICON India 2026 venue → Yashobhoomi, New Delhi.

## Delhi Declaration on Drylands (3D)

### Why in News?

A joint statement on dryland management adopted in New Delhi.

### Key Facts

- Adopted at the **Dryland Congress 2026**.
- Short name: **3D** (Delhi Declaration on Drylands).
- Static: UNCCD (desertification convention) has its secretariat in **Bonn, Germany**.

### Exam Point

- Dryland Congress 2026 adopted → Delhi Declaration on Drylands (3D).

## Kishau Dam Project moves ahead

### Why in News?

A big multi-state water project got the needed agreement.

### Key Facts

- Estimated cost: **Rs 15,624 crore**.
- Built on the **Tons River**, a tributary of the Yamuna.
- **Six states** signed an MoU with the Centre.

### Exam Point

- Kishau Dam river → Tons River.

## EPFO wage ceiling raised

### Why in News?

More workers will come under compulsory PF coverage.

### Key Facts

- Union Cabinet raised the ceiling from **Rs 15,000 to Rs 25,000** per month.
- About **51 lakh+** more employees may get covered.

- Static: EPFO was set up in **1952**; HQ New Delhi; under the Labour Ministry.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- New EPFO wage ceiling → Rs 25,000 per month.

## India's cheetah population reaches 52

### Why in News?

Progress update four years into Project Cheetah.

### Key Facts

- Total cheetahs in India: **52**.
- Of these, **32 are India-born**.
- Static: Project Cheetah began on **17 September 2022** at Kuno National Park (Madhya Pradesh).

#### 📌 Exam Point

- India's cheetah count (Sept 2026) → 52 (32 India-born).

## Gondhal – India's Oscar entry

### Why in News?

India picked its film for the international feature category.

### Key Facts

- **Gondhal** is a **Marathi** thriller.
- Directed by **Santosh Davakhar**.
- Entry for Best International Feature Film at the **99th Academy Awards**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- India's official entry for 99th Oscars → Gondhal (Marathi).

## Quick Revision

| Topic                                          | Key Fact                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>BIS mark for screen protectors</b>          | BIS certification for smartphone screen protectors mandatory from <b>1 April 2027</b> under <b>IS 19348:2025</b> .          |
| <b>WWF Global Conservation Conference 2026</b> | Opened in <b>Jaipur</b> with delegates from <b>100+ countries</b> ; WWF HQ: Gland, Switzerland.                             |
| <b>Wildlife conservation numbers</b>           | Tiger reserves <b>58</b> , elephant reserves <b>33</b> , Ramsar sites <b>101</b> .                                          |
| <b>Cheetah Radha relocated</b>                 | Female cheetah <b>Radha</b> shifted from <b>Kuno NP</b> to <b>Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary</b> (both in Madhya Pradesh). |
| <b>Brahma Kumaris retreat centre</b>           | President <b>Droupadi Murmu</b> opened the Global Spiritual Palace Retreat Centre in <b>Vadodara</b> .                      |
| <b>Lonely Planet Best in Travel 2027</b>       | <b>Gujarat</b> and the <b>Darjeeling Himalayan Railway</b> made the list.                                                   |

| Topic                          | Key Fact                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FSSAI on 'paneer' label        | FSSAI proposed that <b>non-milk dairy analogues</b> should not use the word 'paneer'.                                             |
| Longest steel slag road        | Guinness World Record for the world's longest steel slag road in <b>Raigarh, Chhattisgarh</b> .                                   |
| Ramanathaswamy Temple at BRICS | Temple at <b>Rameswaram</b> (Tamil Nadu), one of the 12 Jyotirlingas, featured during the <b>18th BRICS Summit</b> .              |
| India Net Zero Portal          | Environment Ministry launched it with the <b>NAPCC Dashboard</b> to track climate goals; India's net-zero target is <b>2070</b> . |
| APEDA–Gulfood MoU              | India will be the <b>Official Partner Country</b> for <b>Gulfood 2027</b> (Dubai).                                                |
| Cheetah cubs at Kuno           | India-born female cheetah <b>KGP12</b> gave birth to <b>four cubs</b> at Kuno NP, Madhya Pradesh.                                 |
| Rs 100 commemorative coin      | Marks <b>1,000 years</b> of the <b>Modhera Sun Temple</b> , Gujarat; notified by the Finance Ministry.                            |
| NGT international conference   | PM Modi opened ' <b>The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics</b> ' at <b>Vigyan Bhawan</b> , New Delhi; NGT set up in 2010. |
| BIO-NIVESH                     | Initiative to boost <b>investment and innovation</b> in India's <b>biotechnology</b> sector.                                      |
| UNCCD COP17                    | India's land-restoration preparations linked to <b>UNCCD COP17</b> ; UNCCD secretariat: Bonn, Germany.                            |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                    |                                 |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Inter-State Council                | Article 263; amended order 2026 |
| Kavach 4.0 first                   | South Central Railway, 108 km   |
| Tiger / Elephant reserves / Ramsar | 58 / 33 / 101                   |
| Cheetahs in India                  | 52 (32 India-born)              |
| EPFO wage ceiling                  | Rs 15,000 → Rs 25,000           |
| India's Oscar entry (99th)         | Gondhal (Marathi)               |
| Kishau Dam                         | Tons River, Rs 15,624 crore     |
| SEMICON India 2026                 | 5th edition, Yashobhoomi        |

## 4. Government Schemes & Policies

### Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 5.0

#### Why in News?

The fifth edition of India's coastal clean-up campaign was launched along with the country's first National Ocean Olympiad.

#### Key Facts

- Covers **100+ beaches**.
- India's coastline: **11,098 km**.
- Introduced India's **first National Ocean Olympiad**.

#### Exam Point

- India's coastline (new figure) → 11,098 km.

### SUMAN Roadmap 2030

#### Why in News?

A roadmap to strengthen maternal and newborn healthcare under SUMAN was released.

#### Key Facts

- Focus: **maternal and newborn healthcare** interventions.
- Coverage: **13 states** and **130 districts**.
- SUMAN = **Surakshit Matritva Aashwasan**, launched in **2019**.

#### Exam Point

- SUMAN Roadmap 2030 → 13 states, 130 districts.

### CBSE Three-Language Policy for Class 9 (2026–27)

#### Why in News?

CBSE introduced a three-language requirement for Class 9 from the 2026–27 session.

#### Key Facts

- Students study **R1, R2 and R3** languages.
- At least **two must be native Indian languages**.
- **R3 will have no Class 10 board exam**.

#### Exam Point

- CBSE three-language rule → at least 2 native Indian languages.

### Quick Revision

| Topic                                 | Key Fact                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Delhi's DURGA Scheme</b>           | Driving Upliftment and Rozgar for Women/Transgender Green E-Auto – <b>jobs + green mobility</b> .               |
| <b>PM Surya Ghar in Delhi</b>         | Combined Centre–state rooftop-solar subsidy of up to <b>Rs 1.56 lakh</b> .                                      |
| <b>Jal Shakti Departmental Summit</b> | Focused on Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari – Catch the Rain and O&M under <b>Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0</b> .             |
| <b>AyurVarta</b>                      | <b>All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA)</b> launched this digital dialogue series ahead of Ayurveda Day 2026. |
| <b>IIT Madras &amp; UNESCO MGIEP</b>  | Partnered for low-cost, open-source <b>AI learning</b> tools with Social and Emotional Learning.                |
| <b>BIO-NIVESH</b>                     | Launched by <b>Jitendra Singh</b> ; links biotech and deep-tech startups with investors.                        |

### **At a Glance (Revision Box)**

|                                          |                                           |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 5.0</b> | 100+ beaches; 1st National Ocean Olympiad |
| <b>SUMAN Roadmap 2030</b>                | 13 states, 130 districts                  |
| <b>PM Surya Ghar (Delhi)</b>             | Subsidy up to Rs 1.56 lakh                |
| <b>BIO-NIVESH</b>                        | Biotech startups–investors platform       |

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## 5. States in News

### Delhi launches PM Surya Ghar Portal

#### Why in News?

Delhi made it easier to apply for rooftop solar support.

#### Key Facts

- Rooftop solar subsidy of up to **Rs 1.56 lakh** in Delhi.
- Linked to the central **PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana**.
- Static: the central scheme (launched 2024) offers up to **300 units** of free power a month to **1 crore** households.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Delhi rooftop solar subsidy (max) → Rs 1.56 lakh.

### AFSPA extended in three North-East states

#### Why in News?

Special powers for armed forces continued in disturbed areas.

#### Key Facts

- Extended from **1 October 2026 to 31 March 2027**.
- Applies in specified areas of **Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh**.
- Static: AFSPA was enacted in **1958**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- AFSPA extension period → 1 Oct 2026 to 31 Mar 2027.

### West Bengal Public Safety Bill returned

#### Why in News?

The President sent a state bill back to the legislature.

#### Key Facts

- The President returned the **West Bengal Public Safety Bill 2026**.
- It was sent back **for reconsideration**.
- Static: under **Article 201**, the President can direct return of a reserved state bill; the House must reconsider within **6 months**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Reserved state bill returned by President → Article 201.

## World Circular Economy Forum 2026 in Gujarat

### Why in News?

A global forum on circular economy was held in India.

### Key Facts

- Host city: **Gandhinagar**, Gujarat.
- Theme: '**Circular Economy: Transition for People and Prosperity**'.
- Static: WCEF was started by **Sitra** (Finnish Innovation Fund) in 2017.

#### Exam Point

- WCEF 2026 host → Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

## Karnataka gives Tulu extra official status

### Why in News?

A boost for the main language of coastal Karnataka.

### Key Facts

- Tulu got **additional administrative language** status.
- Applies in **Udupi and Dakshina Kannada** districts.
- Static: Tulu is **not** in the Eighth Schedule, which lists **22** languages.

#### Exam Point

- Tulu additional administrative language districts → Udupi & Dakshina Kannada.

## Ladakh: first Heritage Village and twin flower fields

### Why in News?

Two tourism and heritage firsts from Ladakh.

### Key Facts

- **Kumik** in **Zaskar** became Ladakh's **first Heritage Village**.
- Twin flower fields opened at **Choglamsar and Stakna**.
- The fields are at **10,600 ft** and spread over **40 acres**.

#### Exam Point

- Ladakh's first Heritage Village → Kumik (Zaskar).

## Quick Revision

| Topic                              | Key Fact                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assam e-Office deadline            | <b>1 January 2027</b> fixed for full e-Office use; all <b>58</b> Secretariat departments already on it. |
| Andhra Pradesh: CDMP & SafeStay AP | AP Police launched the <b>CDMP Drone Portal</b> and <b>SafeStay AP App</b> for AI-based monitoring.     |

| Topic                           | Key Fact                                                                              |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Delhi DURGA Scheme              | Green <b>e-auto</b> jobs for <b>women and transgender</b> persons.                    |
| Bharat Taxi expands in UP       | Now in <b>Lucknow, Gorakhpur, Varanasi, Kanpur and Prayagraj</b> .                    |
| Sikkim: Chirbiry River Fest     | Held on the <b>Rangreet River</b> (a Teesta tributary) for river conservation.        |
| Maharashtra drought             | Drought declared in <b>265 of 358</b> talukas with a <b>12-point</b> relief package.  |
| Gujarat Child Protection Policy | <b>State Child Protection Policy 2026</b> with <b>zero tolerance</b> for child abuse. |
| Odisha Silicon Valley           | <b>870-acre</b> hub at <b>Naraj, Cuttack</b> for semiconductor and IT units.          |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                               |                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| AFSPA extended (Manipur, Nagaland, Arunachal) | 1 Oct 2026 – 31 Mar 2027   |
| WCEF 2026                                     | Gandhinagar, Gujarat       |
| Ladakh's first Heritage Village               | Kumik (Zaskar)             |
| Tulu extra status                             | Udupi & Dakshina Kannada   |
| Assam e-Office deadline                       | 1 January 2027             |
| Maharashtra drought                           | 265 of 358 talukas         |
| Odisha Silicon Valley                         | Naraj, Cuttack – 870 acres |

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## 6. International Affairs

### Quad Tabletop Exercise in Tokyo

#### Why in News?

The four Quad partners tested joint logistics planning for the Indo-Pacific.

#### Key Facts

- India, Australia, Japan and the US held a **Quad tabletop exercise in Tokyo**.
- Aim: strengthen the **Quad Indo-Pacific Logistics Network**.
- A tabletop exercise is a **discussion-based simulation**, not a field drill.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Quad tabletop exercise 2026 venue → Tokyo, Japan.

### India–New Zealand Free Trade Agreement

#### Why in News?

The India–New Zealand FTA gets a fixed start date and full duty-free entry for Indian goods.

#### Key Facts

- The India–New Zealand FTA is set to **come into force on 20 October 2026**.
- New Zealand will give **duty-free access on 100% of its tariff lines** to Indian exports.
- The FTA Bill was earlier cleared by the New Zealand Parliament.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- India–New Zealand FTA effective date → 20 October 2026.

### US Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026

#### Why in News?

A new US law allows heavy tariffs on countries that buy large amounts of Russian energy.

#### Key Facts

- The US House passed the **Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026**.
- It authorises tariffs of **up to 100%** on countries making significant purchases of **Russian energy**.
- Tariffs need **presidential action**; President **Donald Trump** then signed the Act.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Act allowing up to 100% tariffs on buyers of Russian energy → Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, 2026.

## US FY2027 Major Drug Transit/Producing Countries List

### Why in News?

The US annual 'Majors List' named India along with China and Pakistan.

### Key Facts

- The US included **India, China and Pakistan** in its **FY2027 list** of major drug-transit or illicit drug-producing countries.
- The list is issued by the **US President** every year.

#### Exam Point

- Neighbours of India in US FY2027 drug Majors List → China and Pakistan.

## 2027: India–Japan Year of Shared Horizons

### Why in News?

India and Japan will celebrate 75 years of diplomatic ties in 2027 with a themed year.

### Key Facts

- India and Japan named **2027** the **India–Japan Year of Shared Horizons**.
- It marks **75 years** of diplomatic relations.
- India and Japan established diplomatic relations in **1952**.

#### Exam Point

- India–Japan Year of Shared Horizons → 2027 (75 years of ties).

## India at WorldSkills Shanghai 2026

### Why in News?

India sent its biggest-ever team to the global skills 'Olympics'.

### Key Facts

- India sent its **largest-ever delegation of 70 competitors** to **WorldSkills Shanghai 2026** (China).
- India competed in **63 of 64** skill categories.
- India debuted in **11 future-ready** skill categories.
- The WorldSkills Competition is held **every two years**; the 2024 edition was in Lyon, France.

#### Exam Point

- Host of WorldSkills Competition 2026 → Shanghai, China.

## US–Denmark–Greenland Arctic Defence Agreement

### Why in News?

The 1951 defence pact on Greenland has been updated to suit new Arctic security needs.

### Key Facts

- The **US, Denmark and Greenland** signed an updated **Arctic defence agreement**.

- It supplements the **1951 Defense Agreement on Greenland**.
- Greenland is an **autonomous territory of the Kingdom of Denmark**.

#### Exam Point

- Original US–Denmark defence agreement on Greenland → 1951.

## India–Netherlands MoUs on Kalpasar Project

### Why in News?

Dutch water-engineering expertise will support Gujarat's Kalpasar project.

### Key Facts

- India and the Netherlands signed **two tripartite MoUs** on Gujarat's **Kalpasar Project**.
- Kalpasar is a planned freshwater reservoir project across the **Gulf of Khambhat** in Gujarat.

#### Exam Point

- Kalpasar Project (Gujarat) MoUs signed with → Netherlands.

## Group of Friends on Safety & Security of Shipping & Seafarers

### Why in News?

India co-led a new UN-level group to protect ships and sailors.

### Key Facts

- **India and Liberia** launched the **Group of Friends on Safety & Security of Shipping & Seafarers**.
- It was launched during the **UNGA High-Level Week** in New York.
- Liberia runs one of the **world's largest ship registries**.

#### Exam Point

- India's partner in launching Group of Friends on seafarers' safety → Liberia.

## India Signs UN Convention against Cybercrime

### Why in News?

India joined the first comprehensive global treaty on cybercrime.

### Key Facts

- India signed the **UN Convention against Cybercrime**.
- It is called the **first comprehensive global treaty** on cybercrime.
- It will enter into force after **40 ratifications**.
- The UN General Assembly adopted it in **December 2024**; it opened for signature in **Hanoi, Vietnam** (2025).

#### Exam Point

- Ratifications needed for UN Cybercrime Convention to take effect → 40.

## UK Recognises India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme

### Why in News?

Recognition of India's CCTS can lower the carbon border charge on Indian exports to the UK.

### Key Facts

- The UK recognised India's **Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS)** under its **CBAM** framework.
- The **UK Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism** is due to start on **1 January 2027**.
- India's CCTS was notified in **2023** under the **Energy Conservation Act, 2001**.

### Exam Point

- UK CBAM start date → 1 January 2027.

## India–Australia Space Partnerships

### Why in News?

Space-sector ties between India and Australia were expanded at a major Indian space event.

### Key Facts

- India and Australia announced **five space-sector partnerships**.
- They were announced at the **9th Bengaluru Space Expo**.

### Exam Point

- India–Australia five space partnerships announced at → 9th Bengaluru Space Expo.

## UNCCD COP17 in Mongolia

### Why in News?

The UN's top meeting on desertification and land degradation was held in Mongolia.

### Key Facts

- **UNCCD COP17** was held in **Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**.
- Theme: **'Restoring Land, Restoring Hope'**.
- UNCCD (UN Convention to Combat Desertification) was adopted in **1994**; secretariat in **Bonn, Germany**.
- COP16 was held in **Riyadh, Saudi Arabia** (2024).

### Exam Point

- UNCCD COP17 host city → Ulaanbaatar (Mongolia).

## PM Modi–Putin Meet at 26th SCO Summit

### Why in News?

India and Russia held top-level talks on the sidelines of the SCO Summit in Kyrgyzstan.

## Key Facts

- PM **Narendra Modi** and Russian President **Vladimir Putin** met on the sidelines of the **26th SCO Summit**.
- The summit was held in **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**.
- SCO was founded in **2001**; its secretariat is in **Beijing**. India became a full member in **2017**.

### Exam Point

- 26th SCO Summit venue → Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan.

## Quick Revision

| Topic                                     | Key Fact                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| UN chief at BRICS                         | UN Secretary-General <b>Antonio Guterres</b> was scheduled to attend the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi.                             |
| UK nations' self-determination memorandum | Political leaders of <b>Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland</b> signed a memorandum backing democratic self-determination.          |
| Saudi rare-earth find                     | Saudi Arabia announced major <b>rare-earth and uranium</b> resources at <b>Jabal Sayid</b> , Madinah region.                         |
| Canada as EU associate member             | EU Commission President <b>Ursula von der Leyen</b> proposed <b>Canada</b> as the EU's first associate member.                       |
| World Circular Economy Forum 2026         | Concluded in <b>Gandhinagar</b> (Gujarat) with <b>60+ countries</b> taking part.                                                     |
| Oman's Sohar Port                         | Oman promoted <b>Sohar Port</b> , outside the <b>Strait of Hormuz</b> , as an alternative gateway for India's Gulf energy and trade. |
| Asia's richest person                     | <b>Zhang Yiming</b> , founder of <b>ByteDance</b> , topped Asia on the Bloomberg Billionaires Index (~\$105 billion).                |
| Greensand CO2 storage                     | <b>Denmark</b> opened the Greensand CO2 storage project under the <b>North Sea</b> at the old Nini West oil field.                   |
| Fiji HIV crisis                           | <b>Fiji</b> declared its HIV outbreak a <b>national health crisis</b> after a sharp rise in infections.                              |
| Saudi exits mBridge                       | Saudi Arabia withdrew from <b>Project mBridge</b> , a cross-border <b>CBDC</b> (central bank digital currency) initiative.           |
| US-China AI channel                       | The US and China set up a new <b>AI incident communication channel</b> .                                                             |
| Anak Krakatau eruption                    | Indonesia's <b>Mount Anak Krakatau</b> ('Child of Krakatau', emerged 1927) erupted, sending ash to ~ <b>50,000 ft</b> .              |
| India-Sweden AI corridor                  | AI cooperation boosted through the <b>Sweden-India Technology and AI Corridor (SITAC)</b> .                                          |
| BAPS temple in France                     | France's first traditional stone Hindu temple, <b>BAPS Swaminarayan Mandir</b> , opened at <b>Bussy-Saint-Georges</b> near Paris.    |
| India-Morocco defence                     | First <b>India-Morocco Joint Defence Committee</b> meeting held; defence MoU had been signed in <b>September 2025</b> .              |

| Topic                                     | Key Fact                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ecuador red alert</b>                  | <b>Ecuador</b> declared a nationwide <b>red alert over El Niño</b> (drought, wildfire risk).                          |
| <b>4th Indo-German Environment Forum</b>  | Theme: ' <b>Together For More Resilience</b> '.                                                                       |
| <b>Belgian PM in India</b>                | Belgian PM <b>Bart De Wever</b> visited India on <b>2–4 September 2026</b> (trade, defence, technology, renewables).  |
| <b>Italy's longest-serving government</b> | PM <b>Giorgia Meloni</b> 's government completed <b>1,413 consecutive days</b> , the longest in the Italian Republic. |
| <b>SCO Tourism &amp; Cultural Capital</b> | <b>Lahore</b> (Pakistan) named SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital for <b>2026–27</b> .                                  |
| <b>Malaysia haze emergency</b>            | Emergency declared in <b>Serian, Sarawak</b> after the Air Pollution Index hit <b>519</b> due to cross-border haze.   |

|  <b>At a Glance (Revision Box)</b> |                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>India–NZ FTA in force</b>                                                                                        | 20 October 2026; 100% duty-free lines for India          |
| <b>26th SCO Summit</b>                                                                                              | Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan                                      |
| <b>UNCCD COP17</b>                                                                                                  | Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia – 'Restoring Land, Restoring Hope' |
| <b>UN Cybercrime Convention</b>                                                                                     | Needs 40 ratifications; India signed                     |
| <b>UK CBAM start</b>                                                                                                | 1 January 2027; recognises India's CCTS                  |
| <b>WorldSkills Shanghai 2026</b>                                                                                    | 70 Indian competitors; 63 of 64 categories               |
| <b>SCO Tourism &amp; Cultural Capital 2026–27</b>                                                                   | Lahore                                                   |

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## 7. Economy & Business

### ONGC finds gas in the Mahanadi Offshore Basin

#### Why in News?

A new domestic gas find supports India's aim of cutting energy imports.

#### Key Facts

- Discovery by **ONGC** in the **Mahanadi Offshore Basin** (off Odisha coast).
- Made under the **Samudra Manthan** programme for deep-sea exploration.
- Static GK: ONGC was set up in **1956**.

#### Exam Point

- ONGC's Mahanadi offshore gas find came under → Samudra Manthan programme.

### India's FDI inflow hits record high in FY2025-26

#### Why in News?

Record FDI shows strong investor confidence in India.

#### Key Facts

- Highest-ever annual FDI inflow: **USD 94.53 billion** in **FY2025-26**.
- Cumulative FDI from FY2014-15 to FY2025-26: **USD 843 billion**.

#### Exam Point

- India's record annual FDI (FY2025-26) → USD 94.53 billion.

### India meets fiscal-deficit target for FY2025-26

#### Why in News?

Meeting the target signals fiscal discipline, which rating agencies watch closely.

#### Key Facts

- Fiscal deficit: **4.4% of GDP** in FY2025-26 – target achieved.
- In money terms: about **Rs 15.19 trillion**.
- Static GK: Fiscal targets are guided by the **FRBM Act, 2003**.

#### Exam Point

- India's FY2025-26 fiscal deficit → 4.4% of GDP.

### Maruti Suzuki commissions its first green-hydrogen plant

#### Why in News?

An automaker producing green hydrogen supports clean manufacturing and India's hydrogen goals.

## Key Facts

- Maruti Suzuki's first **green-hydrogen electrolyser plant** at **Manesar, Haryana**.
- Pilot plant capacity: **300 kW**.
- Static GK: **National Green Hydrogen Mission** was approved in **January 2023**.

### 📌 Exam Point

- Maruti Suzuki's first green-hydrogen plant → Manesar, Haryana (300 kW).

## Coal sector gets India's first sector-wide CSR framework

### Why in News?

A common framework makes CSR spending by coal companies more planned and uniform.

### Key Facts

- Launched by the **Ministry of Coal** and **Coal India**.
- India's **first sector-wide Comprehensive CSR Framework** for coal companies.
- Developed by the **Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs (IICA)**.
- Static GK: CSR is mandatory under **Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013**.

### 📌 Exam Point

- First sector-wide CSR framework (coal) developed by → Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs.

## Quick Revision

| Topic                                       | Key Fact                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Government borrowing plan H2 FY27</b>    | Govt to raise <b>Rs 7.86 trillion</b> through dated securities in the second half of FY27.                        |
| <b>Global Business Climate Survey 2026</b>  | India ranked <b>1st among 41 markets</b> (survey from the view of <b>Swedish companies</b> ).                     |
| <b>Forex reserves</b>                       | Fell by <b>\$4.9 billion</b> to <b>\$780.8 billion</b> (week ended 11 September 2026).                            |
| <b>Customs duty cut on edible oils</b>      | Crude sunflower oil: <b>10% → nil</b> ; crude soybean and palm oil: <b>10% → 5%</b> (Basic Customs Duty).         |
| <b>Starbucks GCC in India</b>               | Starbucks' first <b>Global Capability Centre</b> in India at <b>Chennai</b> ; about <b>800 jobs</b> in phase one. |
| <b>Berkshire Hathaway leadership change</b> | <b>Warren Buffett</b> stepped down as Chairman (now Chairman Emeritus); <b>Howard Buffett</b> became Chairman.    |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                     |                                                            |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Samudra Manthan                     | ONGC gas find – Mahanadi Offshore Basin                    |
| Record FDI (FY2025-26)              | USD 94.53 billion; cumulative since FY15 – USD 843 billion |
| Fiscal deficit FY2025-26            | 4.4% of GDP (about Rs 15.19 trillion)                      |
| Forex reserves                      | \$780.8 billion (11 Sep 2026)                              |
| Global Business Climate Survey 2026 | India 1st of 41 markets                                    |
| Maruti green-hydrogen plant         | Manesar, Haryana – 300 kW                                  |
| Starbucks first GCC in India        | Chennai                                                    |
| Coal CSR framework                  | Ministry of Coal + Coal India; prepared by IICA            |



## 8. Banking & Finance

### Sagarmala Finance Corporation plans India's first blue bond

#### Why in News?

A blue bond raises money for ocean and maritime projects, so this is a first-of-its-kind issue in India.

#### Key Facts

- Issuer: **Sagarmala Finance Corporation** – India's **maiden blue bond**.
- Base issue of **Rs 600 crore** with a **Rs 500 crore greenshoe option**.
- Tenure: **10-year maturity**.
- Credit rating: **AA+** from **ICRA and CARE**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- India's first blue bond issuer → Sagarmala Finance Corporation (Rs 600 crore + Rs 500 crore greenshoe).

### Coastal Local Area Bank gets Scheduled Bank status

#### Why in News?

Inclusion in the Second Schedule of the RBI Act gives a bank 'scheduled' status and access to RBI facilities.

#### Key Facts

- Bank: **Coastal Local Area Bank Ltd**, headquartered in **Vijayawada** (Andhra Pradesh).
- RBI included it in the **Second Schedule of the RBI Act, 1934**.
- Static GK: RBI was set up under the RBI Act, 1934 and began operations on **1 April 1935**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Scheduled banks are listed in → Second Schedule of the RBI Act, 1934.

### Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026 comes into force

#### Why in News?

The new law updates a 135-year-old Act so that digital and cloud banking records are accepted as evidence.

#### Key Facts

- Effective from **1 October 2026**.
- Replaces the **Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891**.
- Recognises **physical, electronic, digital, virtual and cloud-based** banking records.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026 replaced → the 1891 Act (effective 1 October 2026).

## Indian travellers can now pay by UPI in Uzbekistan

### Why in News?

Uzbekistan joins the growing list of countries where Indians can use UPI abroad.

### Key Facts

- Payment by scanning interoperable **UZQR** codes.
- Based on an agreement between **NIPL** (NPCI International Payments Ltd) and Uzbekistan's **NIPC**.
- Static GK: Capital of Uzbekistan – **Tashkent**.

### Exam Point

- UPI in Uzbekistan works through → UZQR codes (NIPL–NIPC agreement).

### Quick Revision

| Topic                                         | Key Fact                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RBI nod: LIC in ICICI Bank                    | LIC may acquire up to <b>9.99%</b> of ICICI Bank's paid-up capital/voting rights; approval valid for <b>one year</b> . |
| Jio Payment Solutions – cross-border platform | Launched after RBI authorisation as <b>Payment Aggregator–Cross Border (PA-CB)</b> ; partnered with <b>Citi</b> .      |
| NCDEX launches RAINCHNNAI                     | India's <b>second rainfall-based weather derivatives</b> contract, after <b>RAINMUMBAI</b> .                           |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                   |                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| India's first blue bond           | Sagarmala Finance Corporation – Rs 600 crore + Rs 500 crore greenshoe |
| Blue bond rating                  | AA+ (ICRA & CARE), 10-year maturity                                   |
| New Scheduled Bank                | Coastal Local Area Bank, Vijayawada                                   |
| Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026 | In force 1 October 2026; replaces 1891 Act                            |
| LIC in ICICI Bank                 | Up to 9.99% stake allowed by RBI                                      |
| UPI in Uzbekistan                 | UZQR codes; NIPL–NIPC agreement                                       |
| RAINCHNNAI                        | NCDEX's 2nd rainfall derivative (after RAINMUMBAI)                    |

## 9. Defence & Security

### Veer Guardian 2026: India–Japan Air Exercise

#### Why in News?

A bilateral air exercise between the air forces of India and Japan was held at Jodhpur.

#### Key Facts

- Type: **India–Japan bilateral air exercise.**
- Venue: **Air Force Station Jodhpur** (Rajasthan); duration **14 days.**
- Indian aircraft: **Su-30 MKI, Rafale and LCA Tejas.**
- Japanese aircraft: **F-2A fighters.**

#### Exam Point

- Veer Guardian → India + Japan air exercise, Jodhpur.

### Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 (2nd Edition)

#### Why in News?

The Indian Air Force hosted the second edition of its multinational air exercise Tarang Shakti.

#### Key Facts

- Host: **Indian Air Force (IAF).**
- Venue: **Jodhpur**, Rajasthan.
- Edition: **2nd** (the 1st edition was held in 2024).

#### Exam Point

- Tarang Shakti 2026 host → Indian Air Force, Jodhpur.

### DRDO's First High-Value Deep-Tech Deal under TDF

#### Why in News?

DRDO signed its first high-value deep-tech agreement under the Technology Development Fund with Zero MK India.

#### Key Facts

- TDF = **Technology Development Fund** (DRDO scheme for industry).
- Partner: **Zero MK India.**
- Project: indigenous **dilution refrigerator** targeting **20 millikelvin.**
- Use: **quantum technologies.**

#### Exam Point

- DRDO first deep-tech TDF deal → Zero MK India (dilution refrigerator).

## INS Trishul in Exercise VARUNA 2026

### Why in News?

Indian Navy ship INS Trishul took part in VARUNA 2026, the India–France naval exercise, at Toulon.

### Key Facts

- Exercise: **VARUNA** – bilateral **naval** exercise of **India and France**.
- Venue: **Toulon, France**.
- Indian ship: **INS Trishul**.
- Memory tip: **VARUNA** → **India + France** → **Navy**.

### Exam Point

- VARUNA → India–France naval exercise.

## Sanjukta Parashar: First Woman to Lead CRPF's CoBRA

### Why in News?

IPS officer Sanjukta Parashar became the first woman officer to lead the CoBRA force of the CRPF.

### Key Facts

- **First woman officer** to head **CoBRA**.
- CoBRA = **Commando Battalion for Resolute Action**, a specialised unit of **CRPF**.
- CRPF works under the **Ministry of Home Affairs**.

### Exam Point

- First woman to lead CRPF's CoBRA → Sanjukta Parashar.

## 22nd Yudh Abhyas 2026: India–US Army Exercise

### Why in News?

India and the USA began the 22nd edition of their army exercise Yudh Abhyas, held for the first time in a two-theatre format.

### Key Facts

- Countries: **India – USA** (army exercise).
- Edition: **22nd**.
- Two theatres: **Mahajan (Rajasthan)** and **Auli (Uttarakhand)**.
- First Indian deployment of the **MLIDS counter-drone system**.

### Exam Point

- Yudh Abhyas → India–US army exercise (22nd edition, 2026).

## DAC Clears Proposals Worth about Rs 1.10 Lakh Crore

### Why in News?

The Defence Acquisition Council approved capital acquisition proposals worth around Rs 1.10 lakh crore.

## Key Facts

- Body: **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)**, chaired by the **Defence Minister**.
- Value: about **Rs 1.10 lakh crore**.
- Approval given as **Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)**.

### Exam Point

- DAC approval route → Acceptance of Necessity (AoN).

## Indian Navy Commissions INS Nipun

### Why in News?

The Indian Navy commissioned INS Nipun, its second Nistar-class Diving Support Vessel.

### Key Facts

- Class: **2nd Nistar-class Diving Support Vessel**.
- Builder: **Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)**, Visakhapatnam.
- Role: deep-sea diving and **submarine rescue support**.

### Exam Point

- INS Nipun builder → Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL).

## Quick Revision

| Topic                                         | Key Fact                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Nomadic Elephant (18th edition)</b>        | India–Mongolia army exercise began at <b>Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand</b> .                                         |
| <b>SLINEX-26 (13th edition)</b>               | India–Sri Lanka bilateral maritime exercise held at <b>Visakhapatnam</b> .                                      |
| <b>DRDO directed-energy laser weapon</b>      | DRDO planned an industry partnership for a <b>30-kW class</b> laser weapon mainly for <b>counter-drone</b> use. |
| <b>Samudra Laksamana (4th edition)</b>        | India–Malaysia naval exercise held at <b>Lumut, Malaysia</b> .                                                  |
| <b>IAF Dronathon 2026</b>                     | Held at <b>Pokhran</b> ; tested UAVs, drone swarms, autonomous operations and counter-drone systems.            |
| <b>Bharat Forge &amp; Pratt &amp; Whitney</b> | Evaluated <b>engine options</b> for a DRDO UAV programme.                                                       |
| <b>Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders (MDL)</b>        | Joined <b>Maharashtra's</b> proposed greenfield shipbuilding cluster.                                           |
| <b>GRSE keel laying</b>                       | Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers laid keels for <b>2 coastal research vessels</b> .                        |
| <b>Eager Lion 2026 (12th edition)</b>         | USA–Jordan exercise; <b>hosted by the US for the first time</b> .                                               |
| <b>Adani Defence AK-203 ammunition deal</b>   | <b>5-year</b> supply agreement; the 2021 MoD contract covers <b>6,01,427 AK-203 rifles</b> .                    |
| <b>Sagar Manthan</b>                          | India launched the <b>ocean-research vessel</b> Sagar Manthan (Yard No. 3041).                                  |

| Topic                                           | Key Fact                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Dhruva Space &amp; Safran Space (France)</b> | Satellite contracts worth <b>over €5 million</b> , linked to <b>Space-Based Surveillance Phase-III</b> .       |
| <b>Stanzin Tsangyang</b>                        | <b>First woman from Kargil district</b> commissioned as Army officer; first officer from Zaskar district.      |
| <b>INS Mysore</b>                               | Delhi-class guided-missile destroyer took part in <b>Samudra Laksamana 4/26</b> with the Royal Malaysian Navy. |
| <b>4th Tri-Services Future Warfare Course</b>   | Concluded at <b>Manekshaw Centre</b> ; topics: AI, quantum tech, cyber, space, grey-zone warfare.              |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                          |                                       |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Veer Guardian</b>     | India–Japan air exercise, Jodhpur     |
| <b>Nomadic Elephant</b>  | India–Mongolia, Pithoragarh (18th)    |
| <b>SLINEX</b>            | India–Sri Lanka, Visakhapatnam (13th) |
| <b>VARUNA</b>            | India–France navy, Toulon             |
| <b>Samudra Laksamana</b> | India–Malaysia navy, Lumut (4th)      |
| <b>Yudh Abhyas</b>       | India–US army, 22nd, Mahajan + Auli   |
| <b>Eager Lion</b>        | USA–Jordan, 12th                      |
| <b>INS Nipun</b>         | 2nd Nistar-class DSV, built by HSL    |

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## 10. Science, Technology & Environment

### NASA Launches Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope

#### Why in News?

NASA launched the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope to study the large-scale universe.

#### Key Facts

- Rocket: **SpaceX Falcon Heavy**.
- Will study **dark energy, dark matter and exoplanets**.
- Named after **Nancy Grace Roman**, NASA's first Chief of Astronomy.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Nancy Grace Roman telescope launch vehicle → SpaceX Falcon Heavy.

### IIT Mandi Flags 9–12 Critical Glacial Lakes in Himachal

#### Why in News?

An IIT Mandi study identified glacial lakes in Himachal Pradesh that could pose outburst-flood risk.

#### Key Facts

- **9–12 potentially critical** glacial lakes identified.
- Over **2,000 lakes** examined in **Himachal Pradesh**.
- Risk type: **GLOF** (Glacial Lake Outburst Flood).

#### 📌 Exam Point

- IIT Mandi glacial-lake study → 9–12 critical lakes in Himachal Pradesh.

### ISRO Launches GSLV-F17 with EOS-05

#### Why in News?

ISRO launched the earth observation satellite EOS-05 aboard GSLV-F17.

#### Key Facts

- Rocket: **GSLV-F17**; satellite: **EOS-05**.
- Launch date: **4 September 2026**.
- Launch site: **Sriharikota** (Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Andhra Pradesh).

#### 📌 Exam Point

- GSLV-F17 payload → EOS-05 (4 September 2026).

### ISRO Plans Six More Launches This Year

#### Why in News?

ISRO targeted six additional space launches in the current financial year as private space activity grows.

### Key Facts

- Target: **6 additional launches** in the current financial year.
- About **440 startups** are working in India's space sector.
- ISRO HQ: **Bengaluru**; founded **1969**.

#### Exam Point

- Space startups in India → about 440.

## ISRO's Advanced Radar Research Centre under Project NETRA

### Why in News?

ISRO is setting up an Advanced Radar Research Centre under Project NETRA to track objects in orbit.

### Key Facts

- Location: **Chandrapur, Assam**.
- Programme: **Project NETRA** (space situational awareness).
- Expected to detect objects as small as **10 cm** from up to **2,000 km**.

#### Exam Point

- Project NETRA radar → detects 10 cm objects up to 2,000 km.

## IIT Delhi Develops India's First Micro-GPU

### Why in News?

IIT Delhi built India's first working, indigenously designed micro-GPU, a step for chip self-reliance.

### Key Facts

- Developer: **IIT Delhi**.
- India's **first working and demonstrable** micro-GPU.
- Fully **indigenously designed**.

#### Exam Point

- India's first micro-GPU → IIT Delhi.

## Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve: 3,261 Flowering Plants

### Why in News?

A survey recorded the rich plant diversity of the Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve in the Western Ghats.

### Key Facts

- **3,261 flowering plant species** recorded.
- Includes **1,018 endemic taxa**.
- Spread over **Kerala and Tamil Nadu**; in UNESCO's biosphere network since **2016**.

#### Exam Point

- Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve → 3,261 flowering plant species.

## 82.6 GHz Gyrotron Installed on SST-1 Tokamak

### Why in News?

India installed a high-power gyrotron on the SST-1 tokamak to advance nuclear-fusion research.

### Key Facts

- Gyrotron: **82.6 GHz, 400 kW**.
- Device: **SST-1 (Steady State Superconducting Tokamak)**.
- Institute: **Institute for Plasma Research (IPR)**, Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

### Exam Point

- SST-1 tokamak → Institute for Plasma Research, Gujarat.

## Chandrayaan-1 Data Reveals Ancient Australe Basin

### Why in News?

Data from Chandrayaan-1 gave mineral evidence of the ancient Australe Basin on the Moon.

### Key Facts

- Mission: **Chandrayaan-1** (India's first lunar mission, launched **2008**).
- Finding: **mineralogical evidence** of the ancient **Australe Basin**.
- Body studied: the **Moon**.

### Exam Point

- Australe Basin evidence → Chandrayaan-1 data.

## Djibouti Becomes 72nd Signatory of Artemis Accords

### Why in News?

Djibouti signed NASA's Artemis Accords on peaceful space exploration.

### Key Facts

- Djibouti: **72nd country** and **8th African nation** to sign.
- Artemis Accords: launched by **NASA (USA)** in **2020**.
- India signed in **2023**.

### Exam Point

- 72nd Artemis Accords signatory → Djibouti.

## India–France TRISHNA Mission

### Why in News?

The joint India–France TRISHNA satellite will monitor Earth's surface temperature and water resources.

### Key Facts

- Partners: **ISRO (India)** and **CNES (France)**.
- Monitors Earth's **thermal state and water resources**.

- Resolution: **1 km** over oceans and polar regions.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- TRISHNA → India–France thermal-imaging Earth mission.

## ISRO Tests CE20 Cryogenic Engine at 22 Tonnes

### Why in News?

ISRO completed a flight-acceptance hot test of the CE20 cryogenic engine at an uprated thrust level.

### Key Facts

- Engine: **CE20 cryogenic engine** (powers LVM3's upper stage).
- Thrust: uprated **22-tonne** level.
- For mission: **LVM3-M7**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- CE20 engine test thrust → 22 tonnes (LVM3-M7).

## India's HPV Vaccination Crosses 80 Lakh Doses

### Why in News?

India's HPV vaccination programme crossed 80 lakh doses.

### Key Facts

- Milestone: **80 lakh doses**.
- HPV vaccine protects mainly against **cervical cancer**.
- India also makes nearly **60% of global vaccines** (see item 332).

#### 📌 Exam Point

- HPV vaccine → prevents cervical cancer.

## Quick Revision

| Topic                              | Key Fact                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gnani Artha                        | Indigenous sovereign AI stack by GNANI AI, launched by Vice-President <b>C. P. Radhakrishnan</b> .             |
| Türkiye & Artemis Accords          | Türkiye became the <b>71st signatory</b> of NASA's Artemis Accords.                                            |
| Kakapo population                  | New Zealand's critically threatened flightless parrot reached <b>325 birds</b> after the 2026 breeding season. |
| ChatGPT 6 Astra                    | Launched by <b>OpenAI</b> on <b>3 September 2026</b> .                                                         |
| Ahuti Mk II                        | High-speed multirotor <b>defence UAV</b> by Hyderabad startup Ahuti.                                           |
| Microsoft's 4th India cloud region | <b>India South Central</b> cloud region launched in <b>Hyderabad</b> .                                         |
| Gastrodia keyiensis                | Rare <b>leafless orchid</b> found in <b>Arunachal Pradesh</b> .                                                |

| Topic                                        | Key Fact                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Begonia neelamorum</b>                    | New <b>flowering plant</b> species described from <b>Arunachal Pradesh</b> .                           |
| <b>Google's Project Suncatcher</b>           | Explores <b>machine-learning computing</b> on solar-powered satellites in space.                       |
| <b>NASA's PRIMA telescope</b>                | Far-infrared space telescope moved to <b>Phase B</b> ; cost cap <b>\$1.2 billion</b> .                 |
| <b>No. III Space Effects Squadron (UK)</b>   | Royal Air Force's <b>first dedicated military unit for space defence</b> .                             |
| <b>Shrinking double-white-dwarf</b>          | Indian astronomers found a binary with orbital period of about <b>6.24 minutes</b> .                   |
| <b>ISRO-ESA agreement</b>                    | Cooperative Agreement extended until <b>8 January 2032</b> .                                           |
| <b>Badri calf via OPU-IVF</b>                | Female Badri (hill cattle) calf born in <b>Uttarakhand</b> using <b>OPU-IVF</b> technology.            |
| <b>India's vaccine share</b>                 | India makes nearly <b>60%</b> of global vaccines and supplies <b>100+ countries</b> .                  |
| <b>Ingerana aizawl</b>                       | New <b>frog</b> species found near Mizoram University campus ( <b>Mizoram</b> ).                       |
| <b>Elias 2-24 b</b>                          | Confirmed as the <b>youngest known planet</b> , less than 1 million years old.                         |
| <b>Leopardus tilcayo</b>                     | New <b>wild-cat</b> species from Yungas cloud forests of <b>Bolivia</b> .                              |
| <b>Isar Aerospace's Spectrum</b>             | Germany's rocket – <b>first commercial orbital rocket launched from continental Europe</b> .           |
| <b>Buellia maharajensis</b>                  | New <b>lichen</b> species from Kerala's <b>Western Ghats</b> .                                         |
| <b>AlphaGenome Atlas</b>                     | By <b>Google DeepMind</b> ; covers ~ <b>9 billion</b> possible single-letter mutations in human DNA.   |
| <b>AI to track Mithun</b>                    | AI system tracks Mithun behaviour with <b>99.5% mAP@0.5</b> and <b>99.6% recall</b> .                  |
| <b>IITM-C-DOT Samgya &amp; QClairvoyance</b> | MoU to advance <b>quantum technologies</b> ; Samgya is India's National Hub for Quantum Communication. |
| <b>Bakhira Lake (Uttar Pradesh)</b>          | Ramsar Site since 2022; sediments revealed ~ <b>25,000 years</b> of Indian Summer Monsoon history.     |

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### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                 |                                                                                          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GSLV-F17        | EOS-05, Sriharikota, 4 Sept 2026                                                         |
| Project NETRA   | Radar centre at Chandrapur, Assam                                                        |
| Artemis Accords | Türkiye 71st, Djibouti 72nd                                                              |
| First micro-GPU | IIT Delhi                                                                                |
| SST-1 gyrotron  | 82.6 GHz, 400 kW, IPR Gujarat                                                            |
| CE20 engine     | 22-tonne thrust, LVM3-M7                                                                 |
| New species     | Gastrodia keyiensis & Begonia neelamorum (Arunachal),<br>Ingerana aizawl (frog, Mizoram) |
| Bakhira Lake    | UP Ramsar Site; 25,000 years monsoon record                                              |



## 11. Awards & Honours

### Nagaland film 'Angh' wins Platform Prize at TIFF 2026

#### Why in News?

A film from the North-East winning at a top international festival is a notable first for Indian cinema.

#### Key Facts

- Film: **Angh** by Nagaland filmmaker **Theja Rio**.
- Won the **Platform Prize** at the **Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF) 2026**.
- Prize: **C\$20,000** cash.
- **First film** to use TIFF's new **International Feature Film Oscar** pathway.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Platform Prize at TIFF 2026 → 'Angh' by Theja Rio (Nagaland).

### Shantanu Moitra selected for National Lata Mangeshkar Award 2026

#### Why in News?

The award honours excellence in Indian music and is named after the 'Nightingale of India'.

#### Key Facts

- Awardee: composer **Shantanu Moitra**.
- Award: **National Lata Mangeshkar Award 2026**.
- Carries a **Rs 5 lakh tax-free** cash prize and a citation.
- Static GK: Lata Mangeshkar received the **Bharat Ratna** in **2001**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- National Lata Mangeshkar Award 2026 → Shantanu Moitra.

### Booker Prize 2026 shortlist announced

#### Why in News?

The Booker is one of the world's top prizes for fiction written in English.

#### Key Facts

- Shortlist: **6 novels** chosen from **163 submissions**.
- Prize money: **£50,000**.
- Winner to be announced on **9 November 2026**.

#### 📌 Exam Point

- Booker Prize 2026 winner announcement → 9 November 2026 (£50,000).

## UNESCO International Literacy Prizes 2026

### Why in News?

These prizes reward programmes that spread literacy, especially among disadvantaged groups.

### Key Facts

- **Six** global initiatives honoured.
- Each laureate receives **US\$30,000**.
- Static GK: **International Literacy Day – 8 September**; UNESCO HQ – **Paris**.

| Initiative                                              | Country     |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Escuelas LEO Programme                                  | Colombia    |
| Language Friendly School Programme                      | Netherlands |
| Project PAL                                             | Nigeria     |
| Accelerated Education for Out-of-School Displaced Youth | Lebanon     |
| Chiapas Puede State Literacy Program                    | Mexico      |
| Language for Life                                       | Thailand    |

### 📌 Exam Point

- Prize money per UNESCO Literacy laureate → US\$30,000.

## Anant Nag selected for Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024

### Why in News?

It is India's highest award in cinema, given for lifetime contribution.

### Key Facts

- Awardee: veteran **Kannada actor Anant Nag**.
- Award year: **Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024**.
- Static GK: Award instituted in **1969**; first recipient – **Devika Rani**.

### 📌 Exam Point

- Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024 → Anant Nag (Kannada actor).

## National Teachers' Awards 2026

### Why in News?

These awards honour the best school teachers of the country every year.

### Key Facts

- Conferred by **President Droupadi Murmu**.
- Given to **48 school teachers**.
- Venue: **Vigyan Bhawan**, New Delhi.
- Static GK: **Teachers' Day – 5 September** (birth anniversary of Dr S. Radhakrishnan).

### Exam Point

- National Teachers' Awards 2026 → 48 teachers, conferred by President Droupadi Murmu.

## Quick Revision

| Topic                                       | Key Fact                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Roxy Mathew Koll honoured</b>            | Climate scientist selected for the <b>Pavel S. Molchanov Climate Communications Prize</b> .                            |
| <b>Neelima Satyam</b>                       | <b>IIT Indore</b> professor selected for the <b>Devendra Lal Memorial Medal</b> .                                      |
| <b>FAO 100 Women Heroes</b>                 | Mizoram farmer <b>Pi Mari-i Lalrithangi</b> selected; FAO HQ – <b>Rome</b> .                                           |
| <b>Miss World 2026</b>                      | <b>Joheirry Mola</b> (Dominican Republic) – country's 2nd title after Mariasela Alvarez (1982).                        |
| <b>72nd National Film Awards</b>            | Ceremony scheduled on <b>22 September 2026</b> at <b>Ekta Nagar, Gujarat</b> .                                         |
| <b>Borlaug CAST Communication Award</b>     | <b>Karim Maredia</b> – for communicating agricultural science and biotechnology.                                       |
| <b>Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Jan Seva Puraskar</b> | <b>Kishor Makwana</b> ; to be given at the <b>16th Sansad Ratna Awards</b> .                                           |
| <b>First Rajbhasha Kirti Prize 2025-26</b>  | Won by the <b>Department of Financial Services</b> for use of Hindi; Hindi as official language – <b>Article 343</b> . |
| <b>78th Primetime Emmy Awards 2026</b>      | Best Drama Series – <b>The Pitt</b> ; Best Comedy Series – <b>Widow's Bay</b> .                                        |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                           |                                         |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024</b>        | Anant Nag                               |
| <b>National Lata Mangeskar Award 2026</b> | Shantanu Moitra (Rs 5 lakh)             |
| <b>TIFF 2026 Platform Prize</b>           | 'Angh' – Theja Rio (Nagaland)           |
| <b>Booker Prize 2026</b>                  | 6-novel shortlist; winner on 9 Nov 2026 |
| <b>Miss World 2026</b>                    | Joheirry Mola (Dominican Republic)      |
| <b>National Teachers' Awards 2026</b>     | 48 teachers, Vigyan Bhawan              |
| <b>UNESCO Literacy Prizes</b>             | 6 laureates, US\$30,000 each            |
| <b>Emmy 2026 Best Drama</b>               | The Pitt                                |

## 12. Books & Authors

| Topic                                                     | Key Fact                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A Century of Service – The RSS in 100 Acts of Seva</b> | Author: <b>Dr TAMILISAI Soundararajan</b> ; released by Vice-President <b>C. P. Radhakrishnan</b> on 15 September 2026.                  |
| <b>Bhupen Hazarika: Hundred Years of a Wandering Song</b> | Edited by <b>Ankuran Dutta &amp; Nani Gopal Mahanta</b> ; published by <b>Gauhati University Press</b> .                                 |
| <b>Modi Katha</b>                                         | Author: <b>Dr Harish Chandra Burnwal</b> ; launched by Union Minister <b>Arjun Ram Meghwal</b> on 17 September 2026 at IGNCA, New Delhi. |
| <b>Vishwasanchar Hindutva Ka</b>                          | Published by <b>Saptahik Vivek</b> ; released by Vice-President <b>C. P. Radhakrishnan</b> .                                             |
| <b>Thirukkural</b>                                        | Classic Tamil work by <b>Thiruvalluvar</b> ; in news for its <b>Russian translation</b> .                                                |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                       |                                     |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Modi Katha</b>                     | Dr Harish Chandra Burnwal           |
| <b>A Century of Service (RSS)</b>     | Dr TAMILISAI Soundararajan          |
| <b>Bhupen Hazarika centenary book</b> | Gauhati University Press            |
| <b>Thirukkural</b>                    | Thiruvalluvar – Russian translation |

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## 13. Sports

### Brendan Taylor breaks Tendulkar's longest-ODI-career record

#### Why in News?

A long-standing Sachin Tendulkar record has been overtaken.

#### Key Facts

- Zimbabwe's **Brendan Taylor** now has the **longest ODI career**.
- He surpassed **Sachin Tendulkar**'s record.

#### Exam Point

- Longest ODI career (new record) → Brendan Taylor (Zimbabwe).

### Shafali Verma – fastest to 3,000 Women's T20I runs

#### Why in News?

A major batting milestone for India's opener.

#### Key Facts

- **Shafali Verma** became the **fastest** to reach **3,000** Women's T20I runs.
- She is the **third Indian woman** to reach 3,000 T20I runs.
- The first two: **Smriti Mandhana** and **Harmanpreet Kaur**.

#### Exam Point

- Fastest to 3,000 Women's T20I runs → Shafali Verma.

### India qualifies for AFC U20 Asian Cup 2027

#### Why in News?

Indian youth football ends a long drought.

#### Key Facts

- India qualified for the **AFC U20 Asian Cup 2027**.
- This ended a **20-year wait**.

#### Exam Point

- AFC U20 Asian Cup 2027 qualification → India, after 20 years.

### India's contingent at Asian Games 2026

#### Why in News?

India's squad for the 20th Asian Games, Aichi-Nagoya (Japan).

#### Key Facts

- India sent a **503-member** contingent.

- More than **300 athletes** made their Asian Games **debut**.

#### Exam Point

- India's Asian Games 2026 contingent → 503 members (300+ debutants).

## Argentina win FIH Women's Hockey World Cup 2026

### Why in News?

Result of the top event in women's hockey.

### Key Facts

- **Argentina** won the FIH Women's Hockey World Cup 2026.
- They beat the **Netherlands 3-1 in a shootout**.
- The 2026 Hockey World Cups were co-hosted by **Belgium and the Netherlands**.

#### Exam Point

- FIH Women's Hockey World Cup 2026 → Argentina (beat Netherlands).

## Germany retain FIH Men's Hockey World Cup

### Why in News?

Germany successfully defended their world title.

### Key Facts

- **Germany** beat **Spain 1-0** in the final.
- It is Germany's **4th** Men's Hockey World Cup title.
- Germany were also the defending champions (title **retained**).

#### Exam Point

- FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026 → Germany (4th title, beat Spain 1-0).

## Deepti Sharma – most wickets in Women's T20Is

### Why in News?

An Indian now tops the all-time women's T20I wicket list.

### Key Facts

- **Deepti Sharma** became the **leading wicket-taker** in women's T20I cricket.
- She reached **171 wickets**.

#### Exam Point

- Most wickets in Women's T20Is → Deepti Sharma (171).

## Lionel Messi retires from international football

### Why in News?

End of an era for Argentina's greatest star.

### Key Facts

- **Lionel Messi** announced retirement from international football.
- Argentina career: **207 appearances** and **125 goals**.
- He captained Argentina to the **2022 FIFA World Cup** title (Qatar).

### Exam Point

- Messi's Argentina career → 207 matches, 125 goals.

## India to host inaugural ICC Women's Champions Trophy 2027

### Why in News?

First edition of a new ICC women's event will be held in India.

### Key Facts

- Event: **ICC Women's Champions Trophy** – first (inaugural) edition.
- Host: **India**.
- Dates: **14–28 February 2027**.

### Exam Point

- Host of inaugural ICC Women's Champions Trophy 2027 → India.

## Smriti Mandhana – top run-scorer in women's international cricket

### Why in News?

Mandhana now holds the overall women's international batting record.

### Key Facts

- **Smriti Mandhana** became the **highest run-scorer** in women's international cricket (all formats).
- She surpassed **Mithali Raj**.

### Exam Point

- Most runs in women's international cricket → Smriti Mandhana (passed Mithali Raj).

## Asian Games 2026: India win women's cricket gold

### Why in News?

India topped the women's cricket event at Aichi-Nagoya.

### Key Facts

- India won **gold** in women's cricket at the **Asian Games 2026**.
- India beat **Sri Lanka** in the final by **147 runs**.

### Exam Point

- Asian Games 2026 women's cricket gold → India (beat Sri Lanka by 147 runs).

## Mirabai Chanu wins Asian Games weightlifting silver

### Why in News?

India's first Asian Games weightlifting medal in 28 years.

### Key Facts

- **Mirabai Chanu** won **silver** in women's **49 kg** weightlifting.
- Her combined lift was **198 kg**.
- First Indian Asian Games weightlifting medallist since **Karnam Malleswari (1998)**.
- Karnam Malleswari was India's **first woman Olympic medallist** (bronze, Sydney 2000).

### Exam Point

- Asian Games 2026 women's 49 kg weightlifting silver → Mirabai Chanu (198 kg).

## Asian record gold in 10 m air pistol mixed team

### Why in News?

Indian shooters won Asian Games gold with a continental record.

### Key Facts

- **Suruchi Inder Singh** and **Kamaljeet** won **gold**.
- Event: **10 m air pistol mixed team**.
- They set an **Asian record of 484.6 points**.

### Exam Point

- Asian Games 2026 10 m air pistol mixed team gold → Suruchi Inder Singh & Kamaljeet (484.6).

## Sawan Barwal – Asian Games marathon silver

### Why in News?

India's first Asian Games marathon medal in 44 years.

### Key Facts

- **Sawan Barwal** won men's **marathon silver**.
- Time: **2:11:37**.
- Ended India's **44-year wait** for an Asian Games marathon medal.

### Exam Point

- Asian Games 2026 men's marathon silver → Sawan Barwal (2:11:37).

## India win 4th Asian Games women's kabaddi gold

### Why in News?

India regained the women's kabaddi crown.

### Key Facts

- India beat **Iran 37–33** in the final.
- It is India's **4th** Asian Games women's kabaddi gold.
- Gold years: **2010, 2014, 2022, 2026**.
- Women's kabaddi entered the Asian Games in **2010** (Guangzhou).

### Exam Point

- Asian Games 2026 women's kabaddi gold → India (beat Iran 37–33).

## Baranica Elangovan – India's first Asian Games pole-vault medal

### Why in News?

A historic first for Indian athletics.

### Key Facts

- Baranica Elangovan** won **bronze** in pole vault.
- She cleared **4.15 metres**.
- First Indian to win an Asian Games **pole-vault** medal.

### Exam Point

- First Indian Asian Games pole-vault medallist → Baranica Elangovan (4.15 m, bronze).

## Quick Revision

| Topic                          | Key Fact                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alexander Zverev – Grand Slam  | Won his <b>second Grand Slam title of 2026</b> .                                                       |
| Women's Asia Cup               | India won a <b>record 8th</b> Women's Asia Cup title.                                                  |
| US Open 2026 – Women's singles | Won by <b>Elena Rybakina</b> .                                                                         |
| Global Chess League            | <b>Ganges Grandmasters</b> beat Alpine APL Pipers <b>7–5</b> for their first title.                    |
| Archery World Cup Final        | <b>Dhiraj Bommadevara</b> (India) won <b>gold</b> .                                                    |
| ISSF Junior World Cup Shotgun  | <b>Yugan Sakthivel Muthukumar</b> won men's <b>trap gold</b> in Porpetto, Italy.                       |
| Pickleball World Cup (Vietnam) | India's <b>kids' team</b> won <b>silver</b> .                                                          |
| Italian Grand Prix (F1)        | <b>Kimi Antonelli</b> won from 19th on the grid – first Italian winner of the race <b>since 1966</b> . |
| Pickleball World Cup 2026      | India finished <b>4th</b> with <b>41 medals</b> – 7 gold, 17 silver, 17 bronze.                        |
| Sheetal Devi – para archery    | Won her <b>maiden individual gold</b> ahead of the Aichi-Nagoya 2026 Asian Para Games.                 |

| Topic                                                              | Key Fact                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FPAI Indian Football Awards 2026</b>                            | Footballer of the Year: <b>Lallianzuala Chhangte</b> ; Women's Player of the Year: <b>Manisha Kalyan</b> .                             |
| <b>Tuanku Muhriz Trophy 2026 (squash, Malaysia)</b>                | India's <b>Abhay Singh</b> beat Henry Leung <b>3-2</b> .                                                                               |
| <b>Vaibhav Sooryavanshi</b>                                        | At <b>15 years 157 days</b> , youngest to score a <b>Duleep Trophy</b> half-century.                                                   |
| <b>Olympic City, Chennai</b>                                       | <b>Tamil Nadu</b> plans a world-class Olympic City with high-performance training, sports science and sports medicine.                 |
| <b>Hyundai World Archery Para Series 2026 – Stage 3</b>            | Hosted by India in <b>Ahmedabad</b> , 5–9 September.                                                                                   |
| <b>IPF World Sub-Junior &amp; Junior Classic Powerlifting 2026</b> | <b>Keyaa Kunal Banerji</b> won <b>deadlift silver</b> (Junior Women's 47 kg).                                                          |
| <b>Suzuki Cup T20I – India vs Japan</b>                            | One-off match on <b>22 September 2026</b> to mark <b>75 years</b> of India–Japan diplomatic ties.                                      |
| <b>Suchika Tariyal – MMA</b>                                       | India's <b>first Asian Games medallist in mixed martial arts</b> (bronze).                                                             |
| <b>Smriti Mandhana – Women's T20I record</b>                       | Became <b>highest run-scorer in Women's T20Is</b> , passing <b>Suzie Bates</b> .                                                       |
| <b>Asian Games athletics medals</b>                                | <b>Silver</b> in mixed 4×400 m relay; <b>Seema Kumari</b> won <b>bronze</b> in women's 10,000 m.                                       |
| <b>50 m Rifle 3 Positions team – double silver</b>                 | Men's team silver ( <b>1762-94x</b> ); women's team silver ( <b>1763</b> ) – Tilottama Sen, Vidarsa Vinod Koochalumkal, Ashi Chouksey. |
| <b>Elavenil Valarivan – 10 m air rifle</b>                         | Won women's <b>individual silver</b> and was part of India's <b>team silver</b> .                                                      |
| <b>Chess Olympiad – Round 7</b>                                    | India beat <b>England 2.5–1.5</b> .                                                                                                    |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                                               |                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FIH Men's Hockey WC 2026</b>               | Germany (4th title) beat Spain 1–0                     |
| <b>FIH Women's Hockey WC 2026</b>             | Argentina beat Netherlands (3–1 shootout)              |
| <b>Most Women's T20I wickets</b>              | Deepti Sharma – 171                                    |
| <b>Most runs: women's intl / Women's T20I</b> | Smriti Mandhana (passed Mithali Raj / Suzie Bates)     |
| <b>Messi's Argentina career</b>               | 207 matches, 125 goals                                 |
| <b>Asian Games 2026 women's kabaddi</b>       | Gold – beat Iran 37–33 (4th gold)                      |
| <b>Asian Games 2026 firsts</b>                | Baranica Elangovan (pole vault), Suchika Tariyal (MMA) |
| <b>Inaugural ICC Women's Champions Trophy</b> | India, 14–28 Feb 2027                                  |

## 14. Rankings & Indices

### Oxford Economics Global Cities Index 2026

#### Why in News?

Delhi was the best-ranked Indian city in the Oxford Economics Global Cities Index 2026, while New York topped the list.

#### Key Facts

- **New York** ranked **1st** globally.
- **Delhi – 268th**, India's highest-ranked city.
- Other Indian cities: Bengaluru 311th, Mumbai 330th, Chennai 381st, Hyderabad 421st.

| City      | Rank |
|-----------|------|
| New York  | 1    |
| Delhi     | 268  |
| Bengaluru | 311  |
| Mumbai    | 330  |
| Chennai   | 381  |
| Hyderabad | 421  |

#### Exam Point

- Top Indian city in Global Cities Index 2026 → Delhi (268th).

### WEF Travel & Tourism Development Index 2026

#### Why in News?

India moved up in the World Economic Forum's Travel & Tourism Development Index 2026.

#### Key Facts

- India ranked **31st among 110 economies**.
- Improved from **39th (2024)** to **31st (2026)**.
- **Japan** topped the index.
- Publisher: **World Economic Forum (WEF)**, HQ Cologny, Geneva.

#### Exam Point

- TTDI 2026: India → 31st; top → Japan.

### Global Gender Gap Index 2026: India 131st

#### Why in News?

India ranked 131st in the WEF's Global Gender Gap Index 2026.

## Key Facts

- Rank: **131st out of 145 economies**.
- Score: **64.5%**.
- Released by the **World Economic Forum** (first published in 2006).

### Exam Point

- India in Global Gender Gap Index 2026 → 131st (64.5%).

## Quick Revision

| Topic                                 | Key Fact                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| QS Global Full-Time MBA Rankings 2027 | IIM Bangalore, IIM Ahmedabad, IIM Calcutta in the world's top 100.                                |
| India Electric Mobility Index 2025    | Delhi ranked <b>1st</b> with 84 points (NITI Aayog & WRI India).                                  |
| Academic Freedom Index                | India placed in the ' <b>severely restricted</b> ' category (cited in Free to Think 2026 report). |

### At a Glance (Revision Box)

|                          |                                        |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Global Cities Index 2026 | New York 1st; Delhi 268th (top Indian) |
| WEF TTDI 2026            | India 31st/110; Japan 1st              |
| Global Gender Gap 2026   | India 131st/145; 64.5%                 |
| E-Mobility Index 2025    | Delhi 1st (84 points)                  |
| QS MBA 2027              | IIM-B, IIM-A, IIM-C in top 100         |

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## 15. Important Days

| Topic                                                                  | Key Fact                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8 September - International Literacy Day                               | Completed <b>60 years</b> of global literacy action in 2026 (UNESCO-led observance). |
| Second Saturday of September (12 September 2026) - World First Aid Day | Spreads awareness about the <b>importance of first aid</b> .                         |
| 24 September 2026 - Bhikaji Cama's 165th Birth Anniversary             | Marked the <b>165th birth anniversary</b> of freedom fighter Bhikaji Cama.           |



## 16. Obituaries

| Topic                             | Key Fact                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Flt Lt Alfred Tyrone Cooke</b> | <b>Vir Chakra</b> awardee and veteran of the <b>1965 Indo-Pak War</b> ; died in New Delhi.                        |
| <b>Tung Chee-hwa</b>              | <b>First Chief Executive of Hong Kong</b> after the 1997 handover; tenure linked with 'One Country, Two Systems'. |
| <b>Dr G. Vijayaraghavan</b>       | <b>Padma Shri</b> -awarded cardiologist; died at 84.                                                              |



## 17. Static GK: Indian Organisations & Regulators

| Topic                                                                                | Key Fact                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>RBI (Reserve Bank of India)</b>                                                   | Est. <b>1 April 1935</b> under RBI Act, 1934; HQ Mumbai; nationalised 1 Jan 1949; first Governor Sir Osborne Smith, first Indian Governor <b>C. D. Deshmukh</b> ; recommended by Hilton Young Commission. |
| <b>SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India)</b>                                 | Est. <b>12 April 1988</b> ; statutory status in <b>1992</b> (SEBI Act, 1992); HQ Mumbai.                                                                                                                  |
| <b>NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development)</b>                  | Est. <b>12 July 1982</b> under NABARD Act, 1981; HQ Mumbai; focus on agriculture & rural development.                                                                                                     |
| <b>ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation)</b>                                     | Est. <b>15 August 1969</b> ; HQ <b>Bengaluru</b> ; predecessor INCOSPAR; founder Dr Vikram Sarabhai; under Department of Space.                                                                           |
| <b>IBBI (Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India)</b>                               | Est. <b>1 October 2016</b> ; HQ New Delhi; works under the <b>Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016</b> .                                                                                                  |
| <b>LIC (Life Insurance Corporation of India)</b>                                     | Est. <b>1 September 1956</b> under LIC Act, 1956; HQ Mumbai.                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>FSSAI (Food Safety and Standards Authority of India)</b>                          | HQ New Delhi; under Ministry of <b>Health &amp; Family Welfare</b> ; governed by Food Safety and Standards Act, <b>2006</b> .                                                                             |
| <b>APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority)</b> | HQ New Delhi; under Ministry of <b>Commerce &amp; Industry</b> .                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>NHAI (National Highways Authority of India)</b>                                   | Est. <b>1988</b> under NHAI Act, 1988; HQ New Delhi.                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>NCB (Narcotics Control Bureau)</b>                                                | Est. <b>1986</b> ; HQ New Delhi; under Ministry of <b>Home Affairs</b> ; key law <b>NDPS Act, 1985</b> .                                                                                                  |

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## 18. Static GK: Constitutional Bodies

| Topic                                                 | Key Fact                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Election Commission of India</b>                   | Est. <b>25 January 1950</b> ; <b>Article 324</b> ; HQ New Delhi; 25 January observed as National Voters' Day. |
| <b>Finance Commission</b>                             | <b>Article 280</b> ; appointed by the President; normally set up every <b>5 years</b> .                       |
| <b>CAG (Comptroller and Auditor General of India)</b> | <b>Articles 148–151</b> ; appointed by the President.                                                         |
| <b>Supreme Court of India</b>                         | Est. <b>28 January 1950</b> ; <b>Articles 124–147</b> ; HQ New Delhi.                                         |



## 19. Static GK: International Organisations

| Topic                                                  | Key Fact                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>United Nations (UN)</b>                             | Est. <b>24 October 1945</b> ; HQ <b>New York</b> ; 193 members; 51 founding members.                             |
| <b>UN General Assembly</b>                             | All <b>193</b> UN members are members; principle of <b>one country, one vote</b> .                               |
| <b>UN Security Council</b>                             | <b>15</b> members: 5 permanent + 10 non-permanent; P5 = China, France, Russia, UK, USA.                          |
| <b>World Health Organization (WHO)</b>                 | Est. <b>7 April 1948</b> ; HQ <b>Geneva</b> ; World Health Day on 7 April.                                       |
| <b>UNESCO</b>                                          | Est. <b>16 November 1945</b> ; HQ <b>Paris</b> .                                                                 |
| <b>FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization)</b>         | Est. <b>16 October 1945</b> ; HQ <b>Rome</b> ; World Food Day on 16 October.                                     |
| <b>UNCCD (UN Convention to Combat Desertification)</b> | Adopted <b>1994</b> ; secretariat <b>Bonn, Germany</b> ; deals with desertification, land degradation & drought. |
| <b>World Bank Group</b>                                | Est. <b>1944</b> ; HQ Washington, D.C.; core institutions <b>IBRD &amp; IDA</b> .                                |
| <b>IMF (International Monetary Fund)</b>               | Est. <b>1944</b> ; HQ Washington, D.C.; born at the <b>Bretton Woods Conference</b> .                            |
| <b>ADB (Asian Development Bank)</b>                    | Est. <b>1966</b> ; HQ <b>Manila, Philippines</b> .                                                               |
| <b>World Economic Forum (WEF)</b>                      | Est. <b>1971</b> ; HQ <b>Cologny, Switzerland</b> ; annual meeting at <b>Davos</b> .                             |
| <b>NASA</b>                                            | Est. <b>29 July 1958</b> ; HQ Washington, D.C.                                                                   |
| <b>ESA (European Space Agency)</b>                     | Est. <b>1975</b> ; HQ <b>Paris</b> .                                                                             |

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## 20. Static GK: National Parks & Species

| Topic                           | Key Fact                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Kuno National Park              | Madhya Pradesh (Sheopur district); known for <b>Project Cheetah</b> .                                    |
| Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary | Madhya Pradesh (Mandsaur & Neemuch districts); on the <b>Chambal</b> river.                              |
| Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve | Kerala & Tamil Nadu (Western Ghats); in UNESCO's World Network of Biosphere Reserves since <b>2016</b> . |
| Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary      | Uttar Pradesh (Sant Kabir Nagar district); <b>Ramsar site since 2022</b> .                               |
| Ramsar Convention               | Adopted <b>1971</b> at <b>Ramsar, Iran</b> ; protects wetlands.                                          |
| Kakapo                          | Flightless, nocturnal parrot of <b>New Zealand</b> ; scientific name <i>Strigops habroptilus</i> .       |
| Red Panda                       | <i>Ailurus fulgens</i> ; IUCN: <b>Endangered</b> ; found in the Eastern Himalayas in India.              |
| Greater One-Horned Rhino        | <i>Rhinoceros unicornis</i> ; IUCN: <b>Vulnerable</b> ; main Indian stronghold <b>Assam</b> .            |

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## 21. Static GK: Space & Technology

| Topic                        | Key Fact                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Satish Dhawan Space Centre   | Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh; India's primary spaceport.                                                              |
| Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre | Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala; develops launch vehicles.                                                                |
| GSLV                         | Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle.                                                                             |
| PSLV                         | Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle; called the <b>workhorse of ISRO</b> .                                                |
| LVM3                         | Earlier called <b>GSLV Mk III</b> ; heavy-lift launch vehicle.                                                       |
| CE20                         | ISRO-built <b>cryogenic rocket engine</b> ; used on LVM3.                                                            |
| Chandrayaan-1                | Launched <b>22 October 2008</b> ; India's first lunar mission; found evidence of <b>water molecules</b> on the Moon. |
| TRISHNA                      | Joint mission of <b>ISRO &amp; CNES (France)</b> ; thermal infrared imaging.                                         |
| Artemis Programme            | <b>NASA</b> programme for human exploration of the <b>Moon</b> .                                                     |

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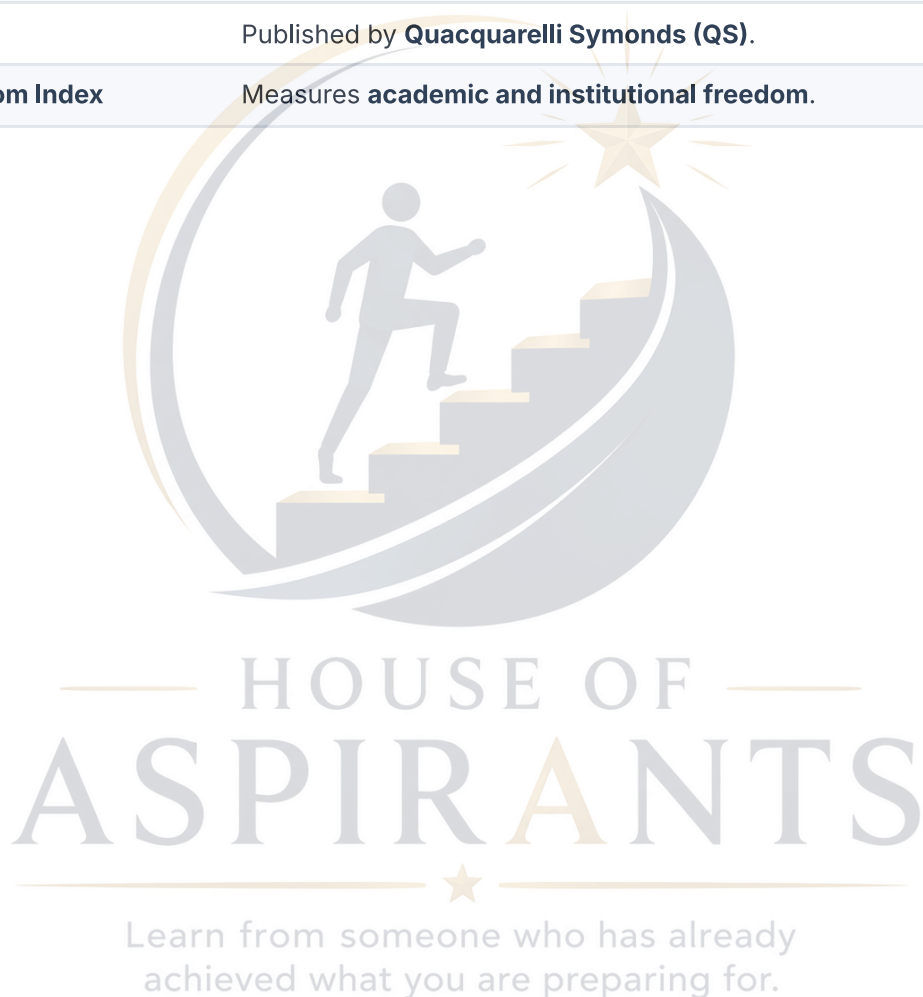
## 22. Static GK: Heritage & GI Tags

| Topic                        | Key Fact                                                                                        |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ramanathaswamy Temple        | Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu; Lord Shiva; one of 12 Jyotirlingas and part of Char Dham.               |
| Modhera Sun Temple           | Gujarat; dedicated to Surya; built in Chaulukya/Solanki era, linked with Bhima I.               |
| Darjeeling Himalayan Railway | West Bengal; opened 1881; UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1999.                                   |
| GI Tag                       | Geographical Indication; GI of Goods Act, 1999; registry in Chennai; valid 10 years, renewable. |
| Gulbarga Tur Dal             | GI-tagged farm product of Kalaburagi (Gulbarga), Karnataka.                                     |



## 23. Static GK: Important Reports & Indices

| Topic                              | Key Fact                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Global Gender Gap Index            | Published by the <b>World Economic Forum</b> .                            |
| Travel & Tourism Development Index | Published by the <b>World Economic Forum</b> .                            |
| Global Cities Index                | Published by <b>Oxford Economics</b> .                                    |
| Global Financial Centres Index     | Published by <b>Z/Yen Group</b> with <b>China Development Institute</b> . |
| QS Rankings                        | Published by <b>Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)</b> .                           |
| Academic Freedom Index             | Measures <b>academic and institutional freedom</b> .                      |



## 24. Practice MCQs - Answers & Explanations

**Q1. By how much did Punjab raise DA/DR in September 2026?**

- A) From 38% to 42%
- B) From 42% to 50%
- C) From 42% to 46%
- D) From 46% to 53%

**Answer: B) From 42% to 50%** — Punjab raised DA for employees and DR for pensioners from 42% to 50%.

**Q2. India's first soil-carbon payments went to farmers of which states?**

- A) Punjab and Haryana
- B) Gujarat and Rajasthan
- C) UP and Bihar
- D) Kerala and Tamil Nadu

**Answer: A) Punjab and Haryana** — Over Rs 2.9 crore was paid to 2,550 farmers of Punjab and Haryana.

**Q3. The Green Forge Complex for GM-crop research was opened at:**

- A) IARI, New Delhi
- B) PAU, Ludhiana
- C) BRIC-NABI, Mohali
- D) IISER, Mohali

**Answer: C) BRIC-NABI, Mohali** — It was inaugurated at the National Agri-Food Biotechnology Institute (BRIC-NABI), Mohali.

**Q4. Who hit a 30-ball T20I century against Afghanistan?**

- A) Shubman Gill
- B) Abhishek Sharma
- C) Suryakumar Yadav
- D) Rinku Singh

**Answer: B) Abhishek Sharma** — Abhishek Sharma (Amritsar) broke the previous Indian record.

**Q5. Where was the 18th BRICS Summit held?**

- A) Kazan
- B) Rio de Janeiro
- C) New Delhi
- D) Johannesburg

**Answer: C) New Delhi** — India hosted it at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi on 12-13 September 2026.

**Q6. How many points does the BRICS New Delhi Declaration 2026 contain?**

- A) 100
- B) 122
- C) 140
- D) 145

**Answer: C) 140** — The 45-page declaration has 140 points and was adopted unanimously.

**Q7. Which country will host the 19th BRICS Summit in 2027?**

- A) Russia
- B) China
- C) Brazil
- D) South Africa

**Answer: B) China** — China will chair BRICS in 2027.

**Q8. Who coined the term BRIC?**

- A) Jim O'Neill
- B) Joseph Stiglitz
- C) Paul Krugman
- D) Raghuram Rajan

**Answer: A) Jim O'Neill** — Goldman Sachs economist Jim O'Neill coined BRIC in 2001.

**Q9. 'Oliy Darajali Do'stlik Order' conferred on PM Modi is the highest honour of:**

- A) Kazakhstan
- B) Uzbekistan
- C) Kyrgyzstan
- D) Tajikistan

**Answer: B) Uzbekistan** — It is Uzbekistan's Order of Supreme Friendship, given in Tashkent.

**Q10. Which of these is NOT a Ramon Magsaysay Award 2026 winner?**

- A) Tommy Koh
- B) Runa Khan
- C) Bo Kyi
- D) Sonam Wangchuk

**Answer: D) Sonam Wangchuk** — The 2026 winners were Tommy Koh, Runa Khan and Bo Kyi.

**Q11. The Ramon Magsaysay Award was started in:**

- A) 1948
- B) 1958
- C) 1962
- D) 1971

**Answer: B) 1958** — It was instituted in 1958.

**Q12. Which city topped Category I (10 lakh+) in Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2026?**

- A) Indore
- B) Lucknow
- C) Jabalpur
- D) Agra

**Answer: B) Lucknow** — Lucknow scored 198, ahead of Indore (197) and Jabalpur (195).

**Q13. The National Clean Air Programme was launched in:**

- A) 2014
- B) 2017
- C) 2019
- D) 2021

**Answer: C) 2019** — NCAP was launched in January 2019.

**Q14. What is the mascot of the 20th Asian Games 2026?**

- A) Miraitowa
- B) HONOHON
- C) Chenchen
- D) Hodori

**Answer: B) HONOHON** — HONOHON comes from 'Honoho', meaning flame in Japanese.

**Q15. The first Asian Games were held in 1951 at:**

- A) Tokyo
- B) Manila
- C) New Delhi
- D) Bangkok

**Answer: C) New Delhi** — New Delhi hosted the first Asian Games.

**Q16. Who were India's flag-bearers at the Asian Games 2026 opening?**

- A) Neeraj Chopra & PV Sindhu
- B) Manu Bhaker & Pawan Sehrawat
- C) Mirabai Chanu & Harmanpreet Singh
- D) Nikhat Zareen & Bajrang Punia

**Answer: B) Manu Bhaker & Pawan Sehrawat** — Pawan Sehrawat replaced Tajinderpal Singh Toor alongside Manu Bhaker.

**Q17. The e-Shram portal was launched on:**

- A) 26 August 2021
- B) 15 August 2020
- C) 1 May 2022
- D) 2 October 2019

**Answer: A) 26 August 2021** — It completed 5 years on 26 August 2026.

**Q18. Under PM-SYM, the assured monthly pension after 60 is:**

- A) Rs 1,000
- B) Rs 2,000
- C) Rs 3,000
- D) Rs 5,000

**Answer: C) Rs 3,000** — PM Shram Yogi Maan-dhan gives Rs 3,000 per month.

**Q19. Kavach 4.0 was first commissioned on which railway zone?**

- A) Northern Railway
- B) South Central Railway
- C) Western Railway
- D) East Coast Railway

**Answer: B) South Central Railway** — It covers 108 route km between Malkajgiri and Kamareddi.

**Q20. The Inter-State Council is constituted under which Article?**

- A) Article 262
- B) Article 280
- C) Article 263
- D) Article 324

**Answer: C) Article 263** — Article 263 allows the President to set up the Inter-State Council.

**Q21. Who publishes the National Formulary of India?**

- A) ICMR
- B) CDSCO
- C) Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission
- D) NITI Aayog

**Answer: C) Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission** — The Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (Ghaziabad) publishes it.

**Q22. How many tiger reserves does India have as per the September 2026 update?**

- A) 55
- B) 56
- C) 57
- D) 58

**Answer: D) 58** — Tiger reserves 58, elephant reserves 33, Ramsar sites 101.

**Q23. Which of these was NOT notified as a mega port under the Indian Ports Act, 2025?**

- A) Paradip
- B) Mundra
- C) Kochi
- D) Deendayal

**Answer: C) Kochi** — The four mega ports are Deendayal, Jawaharlal Nehru, Paradip and Mundra.

**Q24. Where did India set a Guinness record for the world's longest steel slag road?**

- A) Raigarh, Chhattisgarh
- B) Jamshedpur, Jharkhand
- C) Bhilai, Chhattisgarh
- D) Rourkela, Odisha

**Answer: A) Raigarh, Chhattisgarh** — The record road is in Raigarh, Chhattisgarh.

**Q25. The Kishau Dam Project is on which river?**

- A) Sutlej
- B) Tons
- C) Beas
- D) Chenab

**Answer: B) Tons** — The Rs 15,624-crore project is on the Tons, a Yamuna tributary.

**Q26. The EPFO wage ceiling has been raised to how much per month?**

- A) Rs 18,000
- B) Rs 21,000
- C) Rs 25,000
- D) Rs 30,000

**Answer: C) Rs 25,000** — It was raised from Rs 15,000 to Rs 25,000.

**Q27. Which film is India's official entry for the 99th Academy Awards?**

- A) Gondhal
- B) Laapataa Ladies
- C) Homebound
- D) Sairat

**Answer: A) Gondhal** — Gondhal is a Marathi thriller by Santosh Davakhar.

**Q28. The Rs 100 commemorative coin marks 1,000 years of which temple?**

- A) Konark Sun Temple
- B) Modhera Sun Temple
- C) Somnath Temple
- D) Brihadeeswarar Temple

**Answer: B) Modhera Sun Temple** — The Modhera Sun Temple is in Gujarat.

**Q29. Up to how much rooftop solar subsidy is offered on Delhi's PM Surya Ghar Portal?**

- A) Rs 78,000
- B) Rs 1 lakh
- C) Rs 1.56 lakh
- D) Rs 2 lakh

**Answer: C) Rs 1.56 lakh** — Delhi offers up to Rs 1.56 lakh.

**Q30. AFSPA was extended till 31 March 2027 in parts of which states?**

- A) Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura
- B) Manipur, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh
- C) Mizoram, Sikkim, Manipur
- D) Nagaland, Assam, Mizoram

**Answer: B) Manipur, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh** — The extension covers specified areas of Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh.

**Q31. Which city hosted the World Circular Economy Forum 2026?**

- A) Ahmedabad
- B) Surat
- C) Gandhinagar
- D) Vadodara

**Answer: C) Gandhinagar** — WCEF 2026 was held in Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

**Q32. Karnataka gave Tulu additional administrative language status in which districts?**

- A) Mysuru and Mandya
- B) Udupi and Dakshina Kannada
- C) Kodagu and Hassan
- D) Belagavi and Dharwad

**Answer: B) Udupi and Dakshina Kannada** — Tulu is mainly spoken in coastal Udupi and Dakshina Kannada.

**Q33. Which village became Ladakh's first Heritage Village?**

- A) Hemis
- B) Kumik
- C) Turtuk
- D) Alchi

**Answer: B) Kumik** — Kumik is in the Zaskar region.

**Q34. From which date is the India–New Zealand FTA scheduled to take effect?**

- A) 1 October 2026
- B) 20 October 2026
- C) 1 January 2027
- D) 26 March 2027

**Answer: B) 20 October 2026** — The FTA was set to come into force on 20 October 2026.

**Q35. Where was the Quad tabletop exercise on the Indo-Pacific Logistics Network held?**

- A) New Delhi
- B) Canberra
- C) Tokyo
- D) Washington DC

**Answer: C) Tokyo** — India, Australia, Japan and the US held it in Tokyo.

**Q36.** The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, 2026 authorises tariffs of up to:

- A) 25%
- B) 50%
- C) 75%
- D) 100%

**Answer: D) 100%** — It allows tariffs up to 100% on big buyers of Russian energy.

**Q37.** India and Japan have designated 2027 as the India–Japan Year of:

- A) Friendship
- B) Shared Horizons
- C) Innovation
- D) Culture

**Answer: B) Shared Horizons** — 2027 is the India–Japan Year of Shared Horizons, marking 75 years of ties.

**Q38.** How many competitors were in India's largest-ever delegation to WorldSkills Shanghai 2026?

- A) 50
- B) 63
- C) 64
- D) 70

**Answer: D) 70** — India sent 70 competitors and competed in 63 of 64 categories.

**Q39.** India and the Netherlands signed tripartite MoUs on the Kalpasar Project of which state?

- A) Maharashtra
- B) Gujarat
- C) Odisha
- D) Tamil Nadu

**Answer: B) Gujarat** — Kalpasar is in the Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat.

**Q40.** With which country did India launch the Group of Friends on Safety & Security of Shipping & Seafarers?

- A) Panama
- B) Liberia
- C) Greece
- D) Singapore

**Answer: B) Liberia** — India and Liberia launched it during UNGA High-Level Week.

**Q41.** How many ratifications does the UN Convention against Cybercrime need to enter into force?

- A) 20
- B) 30
- C) 40
- D) 50

**Answer: C) 40** — It enters into force after 40 ratifications.

**Q42.** The UK recognised India's CCTS under its CBAM. When does the UK CBAM begin?

- A) 1 April 2026
- B) 1 October 2026
- C) 1 January 2027
- D) 1 April 2027

**Answer: C) 1 January 2027** — The UK Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism starts on 1 January 2027.

**Q43. UNCCD COP17 was held in which city?**

- A) Riyadh
- B) Bonn
- C) Ulaanbaatar
- D) Astana

**Answer: C) Ulaanbaatar** — COP17 was held in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia; COP16 was in Riyadh.

**Q44. The 26th SCO Summit, where PM Modi met President Putin, was held in:**

- A) Astana
- B) Tashkent
- C) Bishkek
- D) Dushanbe

**Answer: C) Bishkek** — The 26th SCO Summit took place in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan.

**Q45. Which city was named SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital for 2026–27?**

- A) Samarkand
- B) Lahore
- C) Varanasi
- D) Bishkek

**Answer: B) Lahore** — Lahore was named SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital 2026–27.

**Q46. Which organisation announced India's maiden blue bond issue?**

- A) NABARD
- B) Sagarmala Finance Corporation
- C) SIDBI
- D) IREDA

**Answer: B) Sagarmala Finance Corporation** — Sagarmala Finance Corporation announced a Rs 600 crore blue bond with a Rs 500 crore greenshoe option.

**Q47. Coastal Local Area Bank, recently given Scheduled Bank status, is headquartered in:**

- A) Visakhapatnam
- B) Kochi
- C) Vijayawada
- D) Mangaluru

**Answer: C) Vijayawada** — It is based in Vijayawada and was added to the Second Schedule of the RBI Act, 1934.

**Q48. The Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026 replaces an Act of which year?**

- A) 1872
- B) 1891
- C) 1934
- D) 1949

**Answer: B) 1891** — It replaces the Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891 and takes effect on 1 October 2026.

**Q49. RBI allowed LIC to acquire up to what stake in ICICI Bank?**

- A) 4.99%
- B) 7.5%
- C) 9.99%
- D) 14.99%

**Answer: C) 9.99%** — LIC can hold up to 9.99%; the approval is valid for one year.

**Q50. ONGC's recent gas discovery in the Mahanadi Offshore Basin was made under which programme?**

- A) Mission Shakti
- B) Samudra Manthan
- C) Project Neptune
- D) Sagar Mala

**Answer: B) Samudra Manthan** — The find came under the Samudra Manthan deep-sea exploration programme.

**Q51. India's highest-ever annual FDI inflow in FY2025-26 was:**

- A) USD 71.3 billion
- B) USD 81.04 billion
- C) USD 94.53 billion
- D) USD 843 billion

**Answer: C) USD 94.53 billion** — FDI reached a record USD 94.53 billion; USD 843 billion is the cumulative figure since FY2014-15.

**Q52. India's fiscal deficit for FY2025-26 was achieved at what percentage of GDP?**

- A) 4.4%
- B) 4.8%
- C) 5.1%
- D) 3.9%

**Answer: A) 4.4%** — The 4.4% target, about Rs 15.19 trillion, was met.

**Q53. Maruti Suzuki commissioned its first green-hydrogen electrolyser plant at:**

- A) Gurugram
- B) Manesar
- C) Hansalpur
- D) Kharkhoda

**Answer: B) Manesar** — The 300 kW pilot plant is at Manesar, Haryana.

**Q54. Who has been selected for the Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024?**

- A) Mithun Chakraborty
- B) Anant Nag
- C) Mohanlal
- D) Kamal Haasan

**Answer: B) Anant Nag** — Veteran Kannada actor Anant Nag was selected for the 2024 award.

**Q55. The film 'Angh', winner of the Platform Prize at TIFF 2026, is by a filmmaker from which state?**

- A) Manipur
- B) Mizoram
- C) Nagaland
- D) Assam

**Answer: C) Nagaland** — Angh is by Nagaland filmmaker Theja Rio.

**Q56. Who was selected for the National Lata Mangeskar Award 2026?**

- A) A. R. Rahman
- B) Shantanu Moitra
- C) Shankar Mahadevan
- D) Amit Trivedi

**Answer: B) Shantanu Moitra** — Composer Shantanu Moitra was selected; the award carries Rs 5 lakh tax-free.

**Q57. The book 'Modi Katha' is written by:**

- A) Dr Tamilisai Soundararajan
- B) Hirav Shah
- C) Dr Harish Chandra Burnwal
- D) Dr Krishna Avtar

**Answer: C) Dr Harish Chandra Burnwal** — Modi Katha by Dr Harish Chandra Burnwal was launched by Arjun Ram Meghwal at IGNCA.

**Q58. Veer Guardian 2026 was a bilateral air exercise between India and which country?**

- A) France
- B) Japan
- C) USA
- D) Malaysia

**Answer: B) Japan** — Veer Guardian is the India–Japan air exercise, held at Jodhpur.

**Q59. Exercise Nomadic Elephant is held between India and:**

- A) Mongolia
- B) Sri Lanka
- C) Nepal
- D) Kazakhstan

**Answer: A) Mongolia** — The 18th edition began at Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand.

**Q60. Which Indian ship took part in VARUNA 2026 at Toulon?**

- A) INS Mysore
- B) INS Nipun
- C) INS Trishul
- D) INS Vikrant

**Answer: C) INS Trishul** — INS Trishul represented India in the India–France exercise VARUNA.

**Q61. Who became the first woman officer to lead CRPF's CoBRA force?**

- A) Sanjukta Parashar
- B) Stanzin Tsangyang
- C) Kiran Bedi
- D) Archana Ramasundaram

**Answer: A) Sanjukta Parashar** — IPS officer Sanjukta Parashar heads CoBRA.

**Q62. The 22nd Yudh Abhyas 2026 used which two locations?**

- A) Jodhpur and Pokhran
- B) Mahajan and Auli
- C) Pithoragarh and Ranikhet
- D) Leh and Kargil

**Answer: B) Mahajan and Auli** — It was held in a two-theatre format at Mahajan (Rajasthan) and Auli (Uttarakhand).

**Q63. INS Nipun, a Nistar-class Diving Support Vessel, was built by:**

- A) Mazagon Dock
- B) GRSE
- C) Cochin Shipyard
- D) Hindustan Shipyard Limited

**Answer: D) Hindustan Shipyard Limited** — INS Nipun was built by HSL, Visakhapatnam.

**Q64. SUMAN Roadmap 2030 covers how many districts?**

- A) 100
- B) 113
- C) 130
- D) 150

**Answer: C) 130** — It covers 13 states and 130 districts.

**Q65. ISRO's Advanced Radar Research Centre under Project NETRA is being set up at:**

- A) Sriharikota
- B) Chandrapur, Assam
- C) Bengaluru
- D) Thiruvananthapuram

**Answer: B) Chandrapur, Assam** — The centre is at Chandrapur, Assam.

**Q66. Which institute developed India's first working micro-GPU?**

- A) IIT Madras
- B) IIT Bombay
- C) IIT Delhi
- D) IISc Bengaluru

**Answer: C) IIT Delhi** — IIT Delhi built the indigenously designed micro-GPU.

**Q67. Djibouti became which numbered signatory of NASA's Artemis Accords?**

- A) 70th
- B) 71st
- C) 72nd
- D) 73rd

**Answer: C) 72nd** — Djibouti is the 72nd signatory and 8th African nation; Türkiye was 71st.

**Q68. The 82.6 GHz gyrotron was installed on SST-1 at which institute?**

- A) BARC, Mumbai
- B) Institute for Plasma Research, Gujarat
- C) IUCAA, Pune
- D) PRL, Ahmedabad

**Answer: B) Institute for Plasma Research, Gujarat** — SST-1 tokamak is at the Institute for Plasma Research, Gujarat.

**Q69. Which country topped the WEF Travel & Tourism Development Index 2026?**

- A) Spain
- B) USA
- C) Japan
- D) France

**Answer: C) Japan** — Japan topped it; India ranked 31st among 110 economies.

**Q70. India's rank in the Global Gender Gap Index 2026 was:**

- A) 129th
- B) 131st
- C) 127th
- D) 135th

**Answer: B) 131st** — India ranked 131st of 145 economies with a score of 64.5%.

**Q71. Who won the FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026?**

- A) Spain
- B) Netherlands
- C) Germany
- D) Belgium

**Answer: C) Germany** — Germany beat Spain 1-0 for its 4th title.

**Q72. Deepti Sharma became the leading wicket-taker in women's T20Is with how many wickets?**

- A) 151
- B) 171
- C) 161
- D) 181

**Answer: B) 171** — She reached 171 wickets.

**Q73. Smriti Mandhana became the highest run-scorer in women's international cricket by surpassing whom?**

- A) Suzie Bates
- B) Meg Lanning
- C) Mithali Raj
- D) Harmanpreet Kaur

**Answer: C) Mithali Raj** — She passed Mithali Raj's tally.

**Q74. Which country will host the inaugural ICC Women's Champions Trophy in 2027?**

- A) England
- B) Australia
- C) India
- D) South Africa

**Answer: C) India** — India hosts it from 14-28 February 2027.

**Q75. Mirabai Chanu won Asian Games 2026 silver in which weight category?**

- A) 45 kg
- B) 49 kg
- C) 55 kg
- D) 59 kg

**Answer: B) 49 kg** — Women's 49 kg, combined lift 198 kg.

**Q76. India beat which team 37-33 to win Asian Games 2026 women's kabaddi gold?**

- A) Iran
- B) South Korea
- C) Nepal
- D) Chinese Taipei

**Answer: A) Iran** — It was India's 4th women's kabaddi gold.

**Q77. Who became the first Indian to win an Asian Games pole-vault medal?**

- A) Seema Kumari
- B) Baranica Elangovan
- C) Suchika Tariyal
- D) Ashi Chouksey

**Answer: B) Baranica Elangovan** — She won bronze with 4.15 m.

**Q78.** Sawan Barwal's Asian Games marathon silver ended India's wait of how many years?

- A) 24
- B) 34
- C) 44
- D) 54

**Answer: C) 44** — He clocked 2:11:37.

**Q79.** Suruchi Inder Singh and Kamaljeet set an Asian record of how many points in 10 m air pistol mixed team?

- A) 482.4
- B) 484.6
- C) 486.2
- D) 480.8

**Answer: B) 484.6** — They won Asian Games gold with 484.6.

**Q80.** Lionel Messi ended his Argentina career with how many international goals?

- A) 105
- B) 115
- C) 125
- D) 135

**Answer: C) 125** — 125 goals in 207 appearances.

**Q81.** Who was the first Indian Governor of the RBI?

- A) Osborne Smith
- B) C. D. Deshmukh
- C) Benegal Rama Rau
- D) I. G. Patel

**Answer: B) C. D. Deshmukh** — C. D. Deshmukh was the first Indian Governor; Sir Osborne Smith was the first Governor.

**Q82.** The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) works under which ministry?

- A) Finance
- B) Health & Family Welfare
- C) Home Affairs
- D) Law & Justice

**Answer: C) Home Affairs** — NCB (est. 1986) is under the Ministry of Home Affairs; key law is NDPS Act, 1985.

**Q83.** Which Article of the Constitution deals with the Finance Commission?

- A) Article 263
- B) Article 280
- C) Article 324
- D) Article 148

**Answer: B) Article 280** — Article 280 provides for the Finance Commission, appointed by the President.

**Q84.** Where is the secretariat of UNCCD located?

- A) Geneva
- B) Nairobi
- C) Bonn
- D) Rome

**Answer: C) Bonn** — UNCCD (adopted 1994) has its secretariat in Bonn, Germany.

**Q85. Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary, a Ramsar site since 2022, is in which state?**

- A) Bihar
- B) Uttar Pradesh
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Odisha

**Answer: B) Uttar Pradesh** — Bakhira is in Sant Kabir Nagar district, Uttar Pradesh.

**Q86. TRISHNA is a joint satellite mission of ISRO with which agency?**

- A) NASA
- B) ESA
- C) JAXA
- D) CNES

**Answer: D) CNES** — TRISHNA is an ISRO–CNES (France) thermal infrared imaging mission.

**Q87. The Modhera Sun Temple in Gujarat is associated with which dynasty?**

- A) Chola
- B) Chaulukya/Solanki
- C) Rashtrakuta
- D) Pala

**Answer: B) Chaulukya/Solanki** — It was built under the Chaulukya (Solanki) dynasty, linked with Bhima I.

**Q88. The Global Financial Centres Index is published by Z/Yen Group along with?**

- A) World Economic Forum
- B) China Development Institute
- C) Oxford Economics
- D) IMF

**Answer: B) China Development Institute** — GFCI is produced by Z/Yen Group and China Development Institute.

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